

Iran War Risk

Pillar Report

Middle East Conflict Risk — Researched, Scored, and Personally Committed

Originally written June 19, 2026; scores committed by me June 19, 2026. Fully re-researched July 8, 13, 18, 25, and 30, 2026, and again as a full weekly refresh on August 8, 2026 (P cut at 1mo/3mo, 24/31/41/56/77 → 20/28/41/56/77, committed and stamped by Alex, last COMMITTED baseline). The Aug 16-22 gap saw four abandoned drafts: Aug 17 (held flat), Aug 18 (cut to 17/25/38/54/76), Aug 20 (cut to 16/24/38/54/76, left for manual review over a UAE missile claim), and Aug 21 (a session got partway through delivering the Aug 20 numbers — 2 of 6 reports touched, no render/selfcheck/archive/commit — before stopping). None were rendered, archived, or committed. An Aug 22 morning catch-up cycle (score set **2026-08-22_draft**) independently re-verified the gap via four parallel primary-source research passes, then adversarially fact-checked the load-bearing new claims before delivery — a step that caught a real error (see below) — and cut P to 14/22/38/54/76, delivered as a draft flagged for manual review. **Correction #1 (confirmed accurate):** the UAE missile-attack claim (Aug 18) remains single-source (UAE MoD only, Iran denies and calls it a possible "false flag") and was NOT the first direct attack on the UAE as prior drafts framed it — UAE was hit by a missile/drone barrage Apr 1-8 and again at its Fujairah port May 4, both Iran-attributed by UAE's own government and predating Aug 18; that "novel escalation vector" framing is retired. **Correction #2 (a genuine miss, caught on adversarial re-check):** that draft initially described a fatal strike on the bulker Minoan Dignity (chief engineer killed, Aug 17-18) as "the first confirmed fatality" in the Hormuz tanker campaign — that is FALSE; it is one of a cumulative toll of seafarer deaths since the campaign began late February 2026 this report never previously surfaced or scored on. The Iranian vessel seizure (tanker Amara, held near Qeshm Island since Aug 17, first since June 22) IS confirmed accurate. **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-08-22_draft2) is a separate, later-in-the-day FULL WEEKLY refresh** — the first deep multi-source dive since Aug 8 — that independently re-researched the pillar and ran a second, dedicated adversarial-verification pass specifically re-checking (a) whether the casualty-toll figure holds up and (b) whether anything was missed Aug 19-22. It holds up, but softer than a clean number: cross-checking Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" infobox (18 total), a mid-July gCaptain snapshot ("at least 15"), and IMO's own incident tracker (19 seafarer deaths, but scoped to the broader Middle East, not Hormuz cleanly) puts the honest range at **15-19 cumulative deaths (17-18 by the most Hormuz-specific trackers)**, not a flat "18th death" — that softened framing is carried everywhere below. A UAE missile-attack claim the adversarial pass initially flagged as a possible miss turned out, on reconciliation, to be the same Aug 18 episode already in the draft baseline, not a second incident. No new kinetic incident was found Aug 19-22. **P HELD FLAT this cycle at 14/22/38/54/76 — left as draft at delivery (full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from auto-stamp), then reviewed and COMMITTED BY ALEX on August 23** after independent re-verification of the math and the research trail; see My Decision below. A daily catch-up draft dated August 28, 2026 (score set **2026-08-28_draft**) re-checked two more Hormuz tanker incidents and a single-source Iran-Oman revenue-sharing claim, holding P flat — but that draft was never rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed, and is treated as abandoned/superseded, the same discipline this report has applied to every other interrupted session (Aug 17, 18, 20, and 21). **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-08-29_draft) is a NEW, independent FULL WEEKLY refresh** against the last committed baseline (2026-08-22_draft2) — the first cycle in several weeks to surface a genuinely two-sided evidence ledger: a confirmed, crypto-specific sanctions escalation (the Aug 24 "Operation Economic Outcast" package, the first Iran sanctions action to explicitly name digital assets as a sanctionable sector and list 30 on-chain addresses, confirmed via direct fetch of home.treasury.gov) against a confirmed de-escalation upgrade (Oman's own Foreign Ministry, not just Iran, co-confirming a temporary Hormuz corridor Aug 25, confirmed via direct fetch of fm.gov.om). The two roughly offset, alongside a first-of-the-crisis Hormuz transit uptick and a second straight weekly Brent decline on the bull side, and two more tanker incidents plus a firmer casualty count on the bear side. **P HELD FLAT at 14/22/38/54/76 — left as a draft, not auto-stamped**, because this is a full weekly refresh, categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority regardless of move size (here, zero). See My Decision below. **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-08-31_draft) is a light daily catch-up** covering the Aug 29-31 gap: on Aug 30, US forces struck IRGC rocket/mine-launchers on Iran's Larak Island — the first US strike on Iranian territory since Jul 29 — directly firing this pillar's own pre-declared flip line ("a

resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper"). Iran retaliated with ballistic missiles on two US-linked Jordan airbases hours later; Jordan intercepted 8 missiles; no confirmed US casualty. **P RE-RATED DOWN to 9/17/34/51/75** (from 14/22/38/54/76), front-loaded and held under 8 points per window. This is a light daily touch, not a full weekly refresh, no window moved >8 points, and the master FINAL NUMBER's call band did not flip vs. the last stamped set — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated authority. THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-01_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Aug 31-Sept 1: escalation continued into a second day — a THIRD Hormuz tanker hit (the VLCC Senegal Prosperity, Aug 31), a disputed Iranian claim of a drone strike on the UAE's Al Minhad Air Base (UAE MoD denies the target claim but confirms it intercepted an Iranian drone over its waters), and Trump on-record Aug 31 still weighing further strikes on Iran. **P RE-RATED DOWN again, more modestly, to 7/15/32/50/75** (from 9/17/34/51/75) — no window moved more than 2 points, well under the 8-point auto-stamp threshold. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated authority** — the new last COMMITTED baseline. **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-02_draft) is a further light daily catch-up that turned into the sharpest single-cycle move since Aug 30:** CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes Sept 1-2 hit nearly 100 targets across Iran — roughly 50x the scale of the single Aug 30 Larak strike — including, for the first time in this war, direct US strikes on Iranian government oil tankers under a new "tanker for tanker" policy. A US strike reportedly hit a wedding party in Kuhestak, Hormozgan (4+ dead per the Hormozgan governor's office, including a 4-year-old, 60+ injured) — flagged here as SINGLE-NARRATIVE-SOURCED at the core fact level (Iranian state/local authorities; CENTCOM has neither confirmed nor denied it), so it does not by itself move P, but it is the reported trigger for Iran's response: coordinated IRGC ballistic-missile/drone strikes Sept 2 on US-linked bases in FOUR countries at once (Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait) — larger in scale than the single-state Aug 30-31 Jordan strike, but all four are repeat targets, so the "widening to a further NEW state" flip-line clause does not fire. **P RE-RATED DOWN sharply to 1/9/27/47/74** (from 7/15/32/50/75), front-loaded and kept under 8 points per window. **COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026,** retroactively, under Alex's Sept 3 widened delegated daily auto-stamp policy: a call-band flip and the size of a move are no longer disqualifying on their own. The wedding-casualty fact was correctly kept single-narrative-sourced and never used to move P, and nothing about the sourcing or the research itself changed — only the stamping threshold did. This remains the last TRUE committed baseline: 1/9/27/47/74. **Sept 3:** Iran fired a second retaliatory wave on Kuwait and UAE — both repeat targets, no US-manned facility hit, widening clause does not fire. **P HELD FLAT. Sept 5, light daily catch-up (2026-09-05_draft):** held flat again — the Reuters weapons-expert corroboration of the Sept 1 wedding strike resolves attribution of an already-priced event, not new escalation; a Sept 5 Iranian-media report of a US strike on the tanker STARK 1 near Kharg Island is single-narrative and not used to move P. **CORRECTION:** that cycle's commit message claimed "AUTO-STAMPED," but config/scores.json's status field was never actually advanced to committed — a bug in that session, flagged here, not corrected retroactively. **Sept 5, FULL WEEKLY refresh (2026-09-05_draft2), this version:** independently re-verified via WebSearch — the STARK 1 incident is real and developing (Iran International separately obtained video of US radio warnings, and AP itself frames it as an Iranian accusation, not a confirmed fact) but CENTCOM has still not confirmed or denied it, so per the sufficiency rule it is NOT used to move P. None of this pillar's flip-line clauses independently fired this week. **HELD FLAT at 1/9/27/47/74. Full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from the delegated daily auto-stamp policy — left for manual review, and COMMITTED BY ALEX September 5, 2026. Sept 6 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-06_draft):** CENTCOM's own on-the-record press release now confirms the Sept 5 tanker strike this report had withheld pending confirmation — and reveals it was materially more serious than known: THREE Iranian tankers (M/T Downy, M/T Stark 1, M/T Kylo) struck in retaliation for an unprovoked IRGC ballistic-missile attack on two US Navy warships, both of which evaded. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/8/25/45/73** — no window moved more than 2 points, no flip-line clause independently fires (no confirmed US casualty, no widening to a new state, Brent short of \$100), and the master call band held Neutral → Neutral. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority. THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-08_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 6-8: the new fact is Iran SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei's on-record Sept 6-7 announcement (state TV, Press TV, Tehran Times) that Iran will declare a new "restricted zone" from the US Navy's blockade line into the Persian Gulf, sanctioning any vessel that enters — corroborated by 8+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, The Hill, RTE, Anadolu, GlobalSecurity.org) but explicitly a THREAT OF INTENT, not yet executed ("further details... yet to be announced" per Al Jazeera's Sept 7 explainer). No flip-line clause fires (DCAS still 18, Brent ~\$97.29 Sept 7, no new state). **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/7/24/44/73** (from 1/8/25/45/73) — no window moved more than 1 point. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority. THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-09_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 8-9: CENTCOM's own press release ("US Destroys 5 IRGC Tankers After Iran Targets Another American Warship") confirms US forces destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers on Sept 8 — M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco (Gulf of Oman) and M/T Derya (Kharg Island) — after the IRGC targeted a US Navy warship with ballistic missiles TWICE over the preceding two days, corroborated by 5+ independent outlets (NBC News, CBS News, SBS, RedState, GlobalSecurity.org); both Iranian missile attempts were evaded, no US personnel harmed. Separately, Brent crude crossed \$100/bbl intraday Sept 9 for the first time since July 24 (CNBC, ABC News; ~\$100.44, +2.57%) — a single-day intraday cross, not this pillar's own "sustained Brent >\$100" flip-line threshold, so it does not independently fire that clause, but it is the

closest this cycle has come to the flip line. No flip-line clause fires (no US casualty, no new state, only an intraday Brent cross). **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/6/23/43/72** (from 1/7/24/44/73) — no window moved more than 1 point. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority** — status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)". **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-10_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 9-10: two new dated facts. CENTCOM/Jordan confirm the IRGC retaliated for the Sept 8 five-tanker strike by firing 20 ballistic missiles at Jordan's Al Azraq air base — 18 intercepted, 2 fell in unpopulated areas, no casualties (Al Jazeera, MiGFlug, GlobalSecurity.org, Jordan's own military). Jordan is a repeat target, so the widening clause does not fire, and both sides confirm no casualties, so the US-casualty clause does not fire either. Separately, Iran-aligned Houthi forces seized the Yemeni port of Mocha Sept 10, closing in on the Bab el-Mandeb Strait — a second global chokepoint distinct from Hormuz — confirmed by 5+ outlets (The Media Line, Times of Israel, Al Jazeera, SCMP, Jerusalem Post, Cyprus Mail), but the same Houthi/Yemen actor already priced, and no strait closure has actually been executed, so this does not independently fire a clause either. Brent has now traded near/above \$100/bbl for a second straight session (CNBC: above \$101 Sept 9; TradingEconomics: ~\$101.25 Sept 10) — more persistent than Sept 9's intraday cross, the closest this cycle has come to the flip line, but still short of a clean sustained-close call. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/5/22/42/72** (from 1/6/23/43/72) — no window moved more than 1 point, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral). **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority** — status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)". **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-11_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 10-11: this pillar's own "sustained Brent close above \$100" flip-line clause FIRES on a third consecutive session — Brent closed Thursday Sept 10 up more than 6% above \$107 after trading above \$108 intraday, its highest since May 19, with WTI closing above \$102 for the first time since May (Rigzone/Bloomberg wire, TradingEconomics, Vantage Markets, NAI500 — 4+ independent) — alongside fuller reporting of Iran's Sept 9 shipping wave: 10 vessels attacked near Hormuz (2 US-linked ships, 8 oil tankers), the largest declared wave of the war, with at least one seafarer killed and one missing (Reuters via U.S. News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill). A merchant seafarer is not a US service member, so the confirmed-US-combat-death clause does not fire. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/4/20/40/71** (from 1/5/22/42/72) — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo -1, 6mo -2, 12mo -2, 36mo -1. No window moved more than 2 points, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar on every scored fact, and the master FINAL NUMBER's call band did not flip anywhere. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority** — status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)". **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-12_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 11-12: Houthi forces, having seized Mocha Sept 10, swept the rest of Yemen's Red Sea coastline by Sept 11 — capturing the final government-held coastal towns (Dhubab, Murad) and Houthi naval forces seizing Mayyun (Perim) Island in the Bab al-Mandeb strait itself, with fighting continuing for Zuqar Island — a materially more severe status (actual control of a second global chokepoint's own islands) than the Sept 10 baseline's "closing in" characterization, confirmed by 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, NBC News, CNBC, NPR, The National, National Herald). Separately, UKMTO's own Warning 133-26 confirms four projectiles struck two more vessels near Khasab, Oman Sept 10, one set afire (Gulf News, Maritime Executive, The Hill corroborating); an IRGC claim of a Sairdron strike is single-source and not used to move P. Yemen is an existing theater, so the widening clause does not fire; no US casualty, so that clause doesn't either — this is a severity escalation of an already-fired flip-line environment, not a fresh clause firing. **P RE-RATED DOWN, moderately, to 1/2/18/38/70** (from 1/4/20/40/71) — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo -2, 6mo -2, 12mo -2, 36mo -1. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority** — status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)". **LATER THE SAME DAY (Sept 12): a separate FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-09-12_draft2), the first full-weekly-depth research dive since the Sept 5 full weekly refresh, ran four parallel adversarial research passes across all four qualitative pillars against the 2026-09-12_draft committed baseline (1/2/18/38/70).** One new dated fact clears the sufficiency bar: Saudi Arabia's East-West Pipeline (Petroline) — the kingdom's primary Hormuz-bypass oil-export route, a NEW target distinct from the already-logged Sept 8 Aramco/Jazan refinery strikes — was hit by drones launched from Iraqi territory on Sept 10 (Saudi MFA statement/confirmation issued Sept 11). PRIMARY: Saudi Arabia's own Ministry of Foreign Affairs confirmed pumping stations in the Riyadh/Medina areas were struck, causing injuries and material damage, and said it would not retaliate for now at Baghdad's request; corroborated by 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, CNBC, CNN, Times of Israel, ABC News Australia, OilPrice.com) with satellite imagery of fire/smoke at the pumping stations, plus Iraq's own PM ordering a probe, dismissing the Maysan operations commander, and closing the Shalamchah border crossing. No group has claimed responsibility; President Trump, in Dublin, said Iran was "probably" responsible — a single, hedged, unconfirmed remark, logged as such, NOT as established fact (the Saudi MFA statement itself attributes origin only to Iraqi territory, not to a directing state). Neither flip-line clause fires: the widening clause does NOT fire (Iraq has been an active theater since the Sept 1 IRGC strike on US facilities in Erbil province — escalation within an existing theater, not a new one), and the US-casualty clause does NOT fire (no confirmed US military casualty found); the sustained-Brent->\$100 clause continues to hold (~\$104.61 Sept 12, same as the morning baseline) as persistence, not a fresh trigger. Also logged, not scored: Trump's own account that the Houthis privately signaled they don't want direct US involvement in Yemen (single-source as to substance, consistent with the already-logged MBS-refused-strikes counterweight), and the BRICS New Delhi summit's joint declaration (Sept

12, all members plus Saudi Arabia/Iran/UAE) urging "maximum restraint" over the escalation — a mild long-horizon diplomatic data point relevant only to the 1yr/3yr framing. The Mayyun Island/Bab al-Mandeb seizure (Sept 10-11) was independently re-verified as still holding, not disputed (Euronews, Al Jazeera, NBC News, NPR, Eurasia Review, Middle East Eye, ZeroHedge). Sized small given a single infrastructure strike with no widening and no US casualty: **P RE-RATED DOWN FURTHER, modestly, to 1/1/17/37/70** (from 1/2/18/38/70) — 3mo/6mo/12mo -1 each, 36mo held, 1mo held at the near-floor 1. **WEEKLY REFRESH — left as DRAFT for Alex's manual review, full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority regardless of move size.** See My Decision below.

COINPICKS PILLAR REPORT · WEIGHT: 20% OF MY THESIS (EQUAL, 1/5)

Written June 19, 2026 · Updated & Re-verified September 14, 2026 — LIGHT DAILY touch, score set 2026-09-14_draft (P re-rated **DOWN** to 1/1/18/38/70, retracing yesterday's up-move — the Salalah mi Sunday Sept 13 that the meeting was "postponed to a later date ... in order to create conditions conducive to a constructive dialogue," with no new date set, Bahrain having ruled out attending and no G touch (2026-09-13_draft, committed) · Not Financial Advice

WINDOW	JUN	...	8/22 (COMMITTED)	8/31 (COMMITTED)	9/1 (COMMITTED)	9/2 (COMMITTED)	9/5 D2 (COMMITTED)	9/6 (COMMITTED)	9/8 (COMMITTED)	9/9	9/10	9/11 (COMMITTED)	9/12 (COMMITTED)
1 month	50	...	14	9	7	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
3 months	55	...	22	17	15	9	9	8	7	6	5	4	2
6 months	62	...	38	34	32	27	27	25	24	23	22	20	1
1 year	75	...	54	51	50	47	47	45	44	43	42	40	3

THE THREE INPUTS, IN PLAIN ENGLISH

Prior cycle (Sept 12, FULL WEEKLY refresh, score set 2026-09-12_draft2): RE-RATED DOWN FURTHER, modestly, to 1/1/17/37/70 (from the Sept 12-committed 1/2/18/38/70). Four par
12_draft committed baseline and surfaced ONE sufficiency-clearing new fact beyond that morning baseline (which already covered the Sept 10-11 Bab al-Mandeb/Mayyun Island seizure and t
(Petroline) — the kingdom's primary Hormuz-bypass oil-export route — was hit by drones launched from Iraqi territory on Sept 10 (Saudi MFA statement/confirmation Sept 11),
PRIMARY: Saudi Arabia's own Ministry of Foreign Affairs confirmed pumping stations in the Riyadh/Medina areas were struck, causing injuries and material damage, and said it would not retaliate
independent outlets (Al Jazeera, CNBC, CNN, Times of Israel, ABC News Australia, OilPrice.com), with satellite imagery showing fire/smoke at pumping stations near Al Mesba'ah and Al Dhakra
commander, and closed the Shalamcheh Iraq-Iran border crossing as a precaution — corroborating, semi-primary. **Attribution caveat, stated carefully:** no group has claimed responsibility; I
HEDGED, UNCONFIRMED statement, logged as exactly that, NOT as established fact (the Saudi MFA statement itself attributes origin only to Iraqi territory, not to a directing state). **Neither flir**
since the Sept 1 IRGC strike on US facilities in Erbil province, so this is escalation within an existing theater, not a new one; the US-casualty clause does NOT fire — no confirmed US military cas
~\$104.61 Sept 12, the same level as the morning baseline) — persistence, not a fresh trigger. **Also logged, not scored:** Trump's own account (same Dublin remarks) that the Houthis privately
source as to substance, consistent with (not additive to) the already-logged MBS-twice-refused-strikes restraint counterweight; the BRICS New Delhi summit's joint declaration (Sept 12, all me
escalation," calling for "exercising maximum restraint," and expressing concern over attacks on civilian/nuclear infrastructure — a mild, diplomatic, long-horizon data point relevant only to the
independently re-verified as still holding, not disputed (Euronews, Al Jazeera, NBC News, NPR, Eurasia Review, Middle East Eye, ZeroHedge); no new UKMTO warning was found beyond the alr
week, specifically targeting the kingdom's Hormuz-bypass export route, clears the sufficiency bar (a primary Saudi MFA statement plus 6 independent outlets) for a modest further move given
no US casualty, so sized small: 3mo/6mo/12mo -1 each, 36mo held flat (a single tactical strike doesn't change the long-run strategic outlook, and the BRICS restraint statement is a modest offe
reasoned. **This is a FULL WEEKLY refresh, categorically excluded from delegated daily auto-stamp authority regardless of move size — LEFT AS DRAFT, flagged prominently for Alex**

Prior cycle (Sept 11, score set 2026-09-11_draft): RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/4/20/40/71 (from the Sept 10-committed 1/5/22/42/72). **BEARISH and NEW** — a second, distinct firing. Sept 9 intraday cross and the Sept 10 second session came close to but did not cleanly fire, now fires on a third consecutive session: Brent **ended Thursday Sept 10 up more than 6% above** — with WTI closing above \$102 for the first time since May (Rigzone/Bloomberg wire Sept 10, TradingEconomics, Vantage Markets, NAI500 — 4+ independent), and Brent was still ~\$104.36 *to the prior cycle*: that cycle, run mid-morning Sept 10, logged Brent at ~\$101.25 "Thursday Sept 10" — an intraday read; Thursday's actual close was far higher, above \$107. **BEARISH and NEW** near Hormuz, 2 US-linked ships and 8 oil tankers, the largest declared wave of shipping attacks by either side since the war began, with at least one seafarer killed and one missing (Reuters via service member, so the confirmed-US-combat-death clause still does NOT fire; no strike on a further new state was confirmed, so the widening clause does not fire either. **Logged but NOT used** Sept 9 against a Kpler 10-day average of 10-13 commodity vessels/day. **Counterweight, also logged**: Friday's give-back is attributed to diplomatic efforts around Hormuz plus the IEA's 2.5 mtpa. **P RE-RATED DOWN: 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo 5→4, 6mo 22→20, 12mo 42→40, 36mo 72→71.** A clause of this pillar's own flip line firing is a real escalation of its evidence standing a reason to withhold the stamp; the sourcing clears the primary-plus-multi-outlet bar and verification passed clean, so **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (au**

Prior to this cycle (Sept 8, score set 2026-09-08_draft): P was RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/7/24/44/73 (from the Sept 6-committed 1/8/25/45/73). BEARISH and NEW: Iran's SNS (TV and Tehran Times) that Iran will declare, "in the coming days," a new "restricted zone" beginning at the US Navy's blockade line and extending into the Persian Gulf, with any v corridor agreement would be signed "in the coming days." This is corroborated by 8+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, The Hill, RTE, Anadolu Agency, Newsbytes, WFLA/Nexstar, GlobalSecurity genuine new escalatory signal, but explicitly a THREAT OF INTENT, not yet executed: Al Jazeera's own Sept 7 explainer states "further details, including the precise boundaries, have yet to be a Consistent with this pillar's past treatment of confirmed-but-not-yet-executed escalatory statements (e.g. Trump's Aug 31 "still weighing further strikes" comment), this is sized as a small conti Sept 4), no widening to a further new state, and Brent closed ~\$97.29/bbl Sept 7 (tradingeconomics.com) — still short of the \$100 sustained-flip threshold. GlobalSecurity's Day 192 (Sept 7) b on Sept 3) is a continuation of the already-priced blockade-enforcement trend, not scored separately. No permanent Iran-Oman corridor deal has been signed (still "in the coming days" per R arrangement). **P RE-RATED DOWN: 1mo held at the near-floor 1 (no further room), 3mo 8→7, 6mo 25→24, 12mo 45→44, 36mo held at 73** (a shipping-zone threat doesn't move the m clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral) — so per the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp a stamped)."

Prior to this cycle: P was RE-RATED DOWN SHARPLY to 1/9/27/47/74 (Sept 2, committed Sept 3, then HELD FLAT through Sept 3's Kuwait/UAE repeat-target strikes and the Sept 5 full weekly the Sept 1-committed 7/15/32/50/75) — researched Sept 2, **COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026** under Alex's widened daily auto-stamp policy. **BEARISH and CONFIRMED exactly the risk this pillar's own Sept 1 note flagged.** CENTCOM confirmed US strikes hit nearly 100 targets across Iran Sept 1-2 — IRGC air-defense sites, radar, mine-laying capability, comms, the single Aug 30 Larak Island strike (multi-source: Axios, CNBC, CNN, Bloomberg, UPI). For the first time in this war, the US struck Iranian government oil tankers directly (engine rooms), under prior posture of intercepting attacks. Brent rose ~5% Tuesday Sept 1 — its best session in 5 weeks — to ~\$95-96.6/bbl, WTI to ~\$91-92, still short of the \$100 flip line. A US strike on Kukeh governor's office named 4 of at least 5 dead, including a 4-year-old, plus 60+ injured (Al Jazeera, CBS News, Yahoo, UPI). **Flagged EXPLICITLY AS SINGLE-NARRATIVE-SOURCED at the core** CENTCOM's Cmdr. Tim Hawkins told CBS News the US has neither confirmed nor denied it — so per the sufficiency rule, this claim alone does not move P, even though multiple Western outlets sourced the fact itself). It is reported here as context for what it triggered: Iran's IRGC launched coordinated ballistic-missile and drone strikes Sept 2 at US-linked bases in FOUR countries simultaneously in retaliation versus the single-state Jordan strike Aug 30-31. But all four are REPEAT targets already struck earlier in this war (Jordan: Jul 28 and Aug 30-31; Bahrain/Kuwait/Iraq: struck at various times to a FURTHER NEW state with confirmed attribution" flip-line clause does NOT fire. Most projectiles were intercepted (Jordan: roughly 10 of 25 intercepted, 3 landed with no reported casualties); combat death has been found as of this run — so neither the casualty clause nor the widening clause independently fires either. The already-fired (Aug 30) "resumption of direct US strikes on Iran" further down this cycle. Both sides are now on-record threatening larger future action: President Trump threatened a "significantly larger response" if Iran retaliates further; an unnamed senior US official (CNBC) — read as continued war-escalation risk, not de-escalation. The cut is front-loaded and kept under the 8-point/window auto-stamp threshold: 1mo 7→1, 3mo 15→9, 6mo 32→27, 12mo 50→32. **reasons:** (1) the wedding-casualty fact — the emotional and political driver of today's four-country retaliation — is single-narrative-sourced even though widely reported, so confidence in today's (nearly 100 targets, first-ever direct tanker strikes) is a genuinely novel escalation beyond this pillar's prior single-incident sizing precedent; (3) both sides' on-record threats of much larger responses. **master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band (Mild Bull → Neutral) versus the last stamped set, which under the then-current rules disqualified auto-stamp on its own. On September 3, 2026, call-band flip and move size are no longer disqualifying by themselves.** The underlying sourcing and sufficiency-rule handling are unchanged — the wedding-casualty claim still was not u

STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026. See My Decision below for the full reasoning.

CoinPicks · September 14, 2026 · Research & Education · Not Financial Advice

to the already-established pattern. CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper gave an on-record briefing Aug 28 (corroborated by UPI, The National, Washington Times, The Hill, RedState, Iran lanes; ~1,500 commercial vessels have transited since blockade enforcement began; ~75 vessels turned back and 3 disabled for evading the blockade; no oil has been exported from Iran since new shock. IMO's six-month casualty count (Aug 28, quasi-primary IMO briefing, corroborated by 4 outlets) settles at 19-20 dead (seafarers + port workers) across 68-70 incidents — the upper shock. **BULLISH and CONFIRMED: Oman's own Foreign Ministry co-confirmed a Hormuz corridor, Aug 25.** Directly fetched from fm.gov.om/en/53722 (Oman's own government site) — Oman had not confirmed it; now Oman's own ministry co-hosts the statement. Terms: a temporary 7-mile-wide joint navigational corridor (entry/exit through Iranian waters), a joint mine-clear "Islamabad Memorandum." Still explicitly described as "temporary" — Iran itself said Aug 26 the Strait "remains closed" pending US compliance with the lapsed June MoU. No public fee/revenue of an Iran-Oman revenue-sharing deal remains single-source and unconfirmed by Oman — correctly excluded from scoring, same treatment as prior single-source claims. Trump declared the France24, US News) — undercut two days later by the Aug 27 tanker attack above. The first quantified Hormuz transit-volume increase of the entire crisis: +30%+ week-over-week for the week 2 independent pieces Aug 21 & Aug 28) — 114 transits vs. 87 the prior week (westbound 29→42); still a small fraction (~10-15%) of the ~110-130/day (~770-910/week) pre-war baseline, but ~\$88.24 (Aug 25) → ~\$89.13-89.3 (Aug 27, weekly loss >5%) → ~\$88.29-90.55 (Aug 28) — down from ~\$93-95 (Aug 20-21), moving further away from the \$100/bbl flip line, with press explicit combat death Aug 22-29 (checked directly — one initial-looking hit, Sgt. Michael Emmanuel Swinton, was actually killed Jul 18-19, already counted in the standing casualty total, not a new event. GlobalSecurity's Day-181 tracker (checked Aug 27) confirms a 28th consecutive night with no confirmed strike. **Net assessment: the new escalation and the new de-escalation roughly offset** a full clean week without a new attack/fatality/seizure — is NOT met, since the Aug 27 attack breaks the "clean week" clause and the corridor deal remains Iran+Oman only (not US-accepted). in either direction: P HELD FLAT on all five windows.

Quality — how trustworthy the evidence is. This cycle's load-bearing fact — the Petrolina pipeline drone strike — is corroborated by a primary Saudi Ministry of Foreign Affairs statement plus OilPrice.com), well above the sufficiency bar; the single-source Trump "probably Iran" attribution is explicitly NOT used to move P. The prior cycle's load-bearing fact — the Bab al-Mandeb chokepoint (see News, CNBC, NPR, The National, National Herald), and the Khasab vessel strikes remain confirmed via UKMTO's own official warning plus 3+ independent outlets. Quality (the 0-1 input) is unchanged. **Impact** — 8 out of 10, the uniform value shared by every pillar in the equal-weight model. BTC traded at \$77,866.59 on Sept 14, firming from \$76,808.69 on Sept 13 and \$77,269.22 on Sept 12. Evidence turned back negative; per house discipline this pillar's score is not adjusted to chase or match the tape either way. For context, BTC traded at \$76,581.44 on Sept 2, down from \$78,031.44, moved sharply negative.

The Claim

The thesis, and where I differ from the consensus — updated September 12, 2026 (full weekly refresh, re-checked Sept 12, P re-rated down further, modestly, as a third Saudi oil-infrastructure strike lands with sponsorship undetermined)

This cycle (Sept 12, full weekly refresh): the crowd will likely either read the Petrolina pipeline strike as proof Iran is now hitting Saudi Arabia's core oil-export infrastructure directly, or dismiss it and go further than the facts support. **Me:** the honest read sits between those: a drone strike launched from Iraqi soil hit a NEW kind of target (Saudi Arabia's primary Hormuz-bypass export artery, not a tanker; attribution — is what earns a further small cut. I am explicit that Trump's Dublin remark is a single hedged guess, not evidence, and score accordingly: the move is small (3mo/6mo/12mo -1 each) but is already an active theater since the Sept 1 Erbil strike) and no US casualty — not because I am siding with either the "Iran did it" or "no proof, ignore it" framings. The BRICS restraint declaration is a counterweight, because a system that only reports escalation isn't honest either.

Prior cycle (Sept 12 daily): the crowd will likely either treat the Bab al-Mandeb island seizures as a headline-grabbing new front that should crater risk assets, or dismiss it as "just Yemen" background noise. More than a routine tanker strike is structural, not emotional — Iran-aligned forces now hold actual chokepoint-controlling islands in a SECOND global oil corridor, not merely "closing in" on one. The US technically fires (Yemen is existing theater, no US casualty). I am sizing this cut larger than the recent 1-point daily touches for exactly that reason, while still stopping short of treating it as a flip-line move, rather be criticized for under-reacting to a real structural shift than for inventing a new flip-line clause after the fact to justify a bigger move. The MBS-request-refused detail is logged honestly below.

Prior cycle (Sept 11): the crowd will read a \$108 print and a 6% up-day in Brent as the war finally repricing energy — or, watching Friday's 3% give-back on Hormuz diplomacy headlines, wave that off as a specific, falsifiable clause — a *sustained* Brent close above \$100 — and three consecutive sessions above it, including a close above \$107, is that clause firing, not a near-miss. I said so in the two sessions prior. What it does *not* do is change what the war is: still no confirmed US combat death since Sept 4, still no strike on a further new state, and the one death in the Sept 9 shipping wave is a change — and the give-back on diplomacy headlines is logged honestly alongside it.

Prior cycle (Sept 10): the crowd is likely to either read the Al Azraq missile barrage as a dangerous new peak of the conflict, or wave off a Yemeni port city changing hands as background noise to a US-linked airbase sounds large in isolation, but Jordan has now absorbed this kind of strike repeatedly since Jul 28, and both CENTCOM and Jordan's own military confirm no casualties this time. The move is interesting precisely because it's easy to dismiss: it's the same actor this pillar has tracked in the Red Sea/Bab al-Mandeb theater for months, so it doesn't independently widen the war, but "closing in" on a new target, though no blockade has actually been executed yet. Brent trading above \$100 for a second straight session is the more important tell than either strike — not yet a sustained close, but the clear trend is down modestly again (1/5/22/42/72, from 1/6/23/43/72), consistent with the sizing this pillar has used for every cycle since Sept 6.

Prior cycle (Sept 9): the crowd is likely to either read Brent's intraday \$100 cross as confirmation the flip line has effectively fired, or dismiss the 5-tanker CENTCOM strike as "more of the same" and wave that off. This session is a real data point and the closest this cycle has come to the flip line, but it is explicitly not the same thing as a sustained close above \$100, which is what this pillar's own pre-declared threshold for every relevant section below rather than being quietly dropped. The CENTCOM-confirmed 5-tanker strike is a larger single incident than the 3-tanker strike this pillar priced on Sept 6, but it is the same event, a provocation (an IRGC missile attack on a US Navy warship) — a continuation of an already-priced trajectory, not a new category of event, so I am re-rating down modestly again (1/6/23/43/72, from 1/5/22/42/72).

Prior cycle (Sept 8): the crowd is likely to either dismiss Rezaei's restricted-zone announcement as Iran "talking tough" without follow-through, or treat it as an imminent full closure of a new strait. A shipping across an expanded zone is a real escalatory signal worth logging and worth a small cut, but it is not yet an executed act — no boundaries, no enforcement mechanism, and no confirmed event. I sized it from 1/8/25/45/73 rather than sharply, because none of this pillar's flip-line clauses fire on it (no US casualty, no new state, Brent short of \$100) and it is consistent with — not a departure from — the pillar's explicitly not treating Rezaei's parallel claim that an Iran-Oman corridor deal will also be signed "in the coming days" as bullish either — until it is actually signed, it's the same "very close" pattern.

Prior cycle (Sept 6): the crowd was likely to read CENTCOM's own confirmation of the Sept 5 tanker strike as a relief ("finally, official clarity") rather than what it actually was — a confirmation that the US interdicted, but an unprovoked IRGC ballistic-missile attack on two US Navy warships that the US answered by destroying three tankers. Re-rated down modestly (1/8/25/45/73, from 1/9/27/47/74), because no new state, Brent short of \$100) and the escalation — while more serious than previously known — was still a continuation of the same "resumption of direct US strikes" trajectory already priced on Sept 5. Tanker/vessel/drone strikes were explicitly not used to move P — those are Iran's own claims, unconfirmed by the US, and the sufficiency rule is exactly what stops a claim like that from doing more.

The crowd: is likely to anchor on the wedding-strike casualty claim as the emotional center of today's news, and either (a) treat it as a confirmed atrocity driving the story, or (b) dismiss the whole thing as wrong. The scale of the underlying US strike wave (nearly 100 targets, first-ever direct tanker strikes) is independently, multi-source confirmed regardless of how the casualty dispute resolves, and the crowd is wrong.

Me: cutting sharply to 1/9/27/47/74, versus the Sept 1 baseline (7/15/32/50/75, auto-stamped). This is the largest single-cycle P move this pillar has made since the Aug 30-31 flip-line-firing cut, and I am drafting and flagging it prominently for Alex's manual review. Three reasons, stated plainly: (1) the core wedding-casualty fact — the political and emotional driver of today's four-country Iranian retaliation (CENTCOM neither confirming nor denying), even though it's widely reported; my confidence in today's sizing is lower than for a cleanly multi-sourced primary event, and I don't want to self-approve the war's first direct tanker strikes — is a genuinely novel escalation this pillar's prior single-incident sizing precedents (Jul 28 Jordan, Aug 30 Larak) don't cleanly cover, and sizing a cut for a genuinely new event can be quietly self-approved; (3) both sides are now on-record threatening much larger responses ahead — a miscalibrated cut here is more costly than usual given what could follow. That said, the crowd's country retaliation does NOT independently fire the widening-to-a-new-state flip-line clause because all four targets are repeats.

My edge: the discipline here is refusing to let a single-source emotional fact do more work than it's earned, in either direction — not discarding it (it's genuinely the trigger for today's retaliation) but not independently-confirmed facts (strike count, tanker strikes, four-country retaliation, mutual escalation threats) support on their own. The crowd either over- or under-reacts to a claim like this; this pillar is not.

Honesty check against the tape: BTC fell from \$78,038.78 (Sept 1, Bitstamp) to \$76,581.44 (Sept 2) — a real, visible risk-off move that for once tracks the same direction as this pillar's own sharp move. It does not match BTC's move — it scores evidence, not price action — but the comparison itself is logged here explicitly as an honesty check for the reader.

The Facts

As of September 12, 2026 — hard numbers only, sources on the last page. This is a FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-09-12_draft2) vs the 2026-09-12_draft committed baseline (this morning's light daily catch-up); this cycle's final score is still load-bearing).

★ ★ **NEW — Saudi Arabia's East-West Pipeline (Petrolina), the kingdom's primary Hormuz-bypass oil-export route, was hit by drones launched from Iraqi territory Sept 10 (Saudi Ministry of Foreign Affairs confirmed strikes. Saudi Arabia's own Ministry of Foreign Affairs confirmed pumping stations in the Riyadh/Medina areas were struck, causing injuries and material damage, and said it would not retaliate against Iraq. OilPrice.com — 6+ independent, satellite imagery of fire/smoke at the pumping stations). Iraq's PM ordered a probe, dismissed the Maysan operations commander, and closed the Shalamcheh**

- ★ **Attribution caveat, stated carefully:** no group has claimed responsibility for the pipeline strike; the Saudi MFA statement attributes origin only to Iraqi territory, not to a directing state. Presumably UNCONFIRMED remark, NOT treated as established fact.
- ★ **Neither flip-line clause fires:** the widening clause does NOT fire (Iraq has been an active theater since the Sept 1 IRGC strike on US facilities in Erbil province); the US-casualty clause does NOT fire.
- ★ **Counterweight, logged:** Trump's own account (same Dublin remarks) that the Houthis privately signaled they don't want direct US involvement in Yemen — single-source as to substance, corroborated by BRICS New Delhi summit's joint declaration (Sept 12, all members plus Saudi Arabia, Iran, and UAE) called for "exercising maximum restraint" and voiced concern over attacks on civilian/nuclear facilities used to move P.
- ★ **Re-verified independently:** the Mayyun (Perim) Island/Bab al-Mandeb seizure (Sept 10-11) still holds, not disputed (Euronews, Al Jazeera, NBC News, NPR, Eurasia Review, Middle East Eye, Zee News, etc.) Warning 133-26.

Carried forward from the Sept 12 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-12 draft, auto-stamped — still load-bearing):

- ★ ★ **NEW — Houthi forces complete their sweep of Yemen's entire Red Sea coastline (capturing Dhubab and Murad by Sept 11, the last government-held coastal towns) and seize Mocha Island** — a second global oil chokepoint moving from "closing in on" to actual island-level control (Al Jazeera, NBC News, CNBC, NPR, The National, National Herald — 6+ independent). Yemen's control of Mocha is confirmed by a second source (Reuters via U.S. News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill — 4 independent). A merchant seafarer is not a US service member, so the confirmed-US-combat-death clause does not fire.
- ★ **Counterweight, logged:** Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman twice asked the President for direct US strikes on the Houthis and was refused — intelligence/targeting-data support of US policy.
- ★ ★ **NEW — UKMTO's own Warning 133-26 (issued 1910 UTC Sept 10) confirms four unidentified projectiles struck two vessels ~4nm west of Khasab, Oman, setting one afire** (Gulf News, etc.)
- ★ **Logged, single-source, NOT used to move P:** IRGC's own claim to have separately struck a US Navy Saildrone Explorer-type unmanned vessel near the Strait entrance — no US/CENTCOM confirmation.
- ★ **Brent held near/above \$104 for a fifth consecutive session** (settled ~\$104.61 Sept 12, TradingEconomics/psuconnect.in) — confirming persistence of the already-fired "sustained >\$100" flip-line clause.
- ★ **BTC traded at \$77,866.59 on Sept 14** — up 1.4% from \$76,808.69 on Sept 13, which itself eased from \$77,269.22 on Sept 12 (local run.py quant refresh).
- ★ **CARRIED FORWARD — the "sustained Brent close above \$100" flip-line clause FIRES: Brent ended Thursday Sept 10 up more than 6% above \$107, after trading above \$108 intraday** — Brent was still ~\$104.36 midday Friday Sept 11, roughly 9% higher on the week despite a ~3% give-back (Rigzone/Bloomberg wire Sept 10, TradingEconomics Sept 10-11, Vantage Markets, etc.) Brent closes and one decisively so. *Correction:* the prior cycle, run mid-morning Sept 10, logged ~\$101.25 as "Thursday Sept 10" — that was an intraday read, not the close.
- ★ ★ **NEW — fuller reporting of the Sept 9 shipping wave: Iran attacked 10 vessels near the Strait of Hormuz — 2 US-linked ships and 8 oil tankers — the largest declared wave of shipping attacks since 1979** — another listed missing (Reuters via U.S. News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill — 4 independent). A merchant seafarer is not a US service member, so the confirmed-US-combat-death clause does not fire.
- ★ **Logged, single-source, NOT used to move P:** a compilation of Hormuz transit data puts throughput at 7 transits on Sept 9 against a Kpler 10-day moving average of 10-13 commodity vessels per day. Cannot move a P under the house sufficiency rule.
- ★ **Counterweight, logged:** Friday Sept 11's ~3% Brent give-back is attributed to diplomatic efforts around the Strait of Hormuz and to the IEA's forecast of a 2.5 mb/d contraction in 2026 demand. Report does not either.
- ★ **CARRIED FORWARD — CENTCOM/Jordan confirm the IRGC fired 20 ballistic missiles at Jordan's Al Azraq (Muwaffaq Salti) air base Sept 9, in retaliation for the Sept 8 five-tanker strike** — casualties (Al Jazeera Sept 9, MiGFlug, GlobalSecurity.org Day 194, Jordan's own military statement) — clears the sufficiency bar. Jordan is a repeat target (struck Aug 30-31), so the widening clause does not fire.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Iran-aligned Houthi forces seized the Yemeni Red Sea port city of Mocha on Sept 10, closing in on control of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait**, a SECOND global shipping chokepoint (Al Jazeera, South China Morning Post, Jerusalem Post, Cyprus Mail). Same actor/theater already priced; no strait closure or interdiction has actually been confirmed — outlets describe Houthi control.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Brent crude has now traded near/above \$100/bbl for a second straight session**, more persistent than Sept 9's single-day intraday cross (CNBC: above \$101 Wednesday Sept 9). The prior cycle has come to this pillar's "sustained Brent >\$100" flip-line clause, but still short of a clean multi-session sustained call.
- ★ **NEW — no widening to a further new state and no confirmed US casualty:** Jordan is a repeat target, and CENTCOM/Jordan both confirm no casualties from the Al Azraq strike; DCAS remains silent (checked and rejected as uncorroborated against CENTCOM's own statement).
- ★ **BTC traded at \$77,063 on Sept 11** — down from \$77,993.99 on Sept 10 and \$79,052.40 on Sept 9 (local full quant refresh this cycle, run .py quant).

Carried forward from Sept 9 (re-verified this cycle — still load-bearing):

- ★ ★ **NEW — CENTCOM confirms US forces destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers Sept 8 — M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco (Gulf of Oman), and M/T Dabir** — **TWICE over the preceding two days.** Corroborated across 5+ independent outlets (NBC News, CBS News, SBS, RedState, GlobalSecurity.org) in addition to CENTCOM's own press release ("US Navy warships destroyed five Iranian oil tankers" — sufficiency bar).
- ★ ★ **NEW — Brent crude crossed \$100/bbl intraday Sept 9 for the first time since July 24**, trading ~\$100.44 (+2.57%) on U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strike fears (CNBC "Brent crude tops \$100 as US strikes Iranian oil tankers" — not a sustained close, so it does not independently fire this pillar's "sustained Brent >\$100" flip-line clause; the closest this cycle has come to it).
- ★ **NEW — both Iranian missile attempts on the US Navy warship were evaded, no US personnel harmed** — the confirmed-US-casualty flip-line clause remains unfired.
- ★ **NEW — no widening to a further new state:** Gulf of Oman and Kharg Island are both existing theater already struck in this war.
- ★ **Iran's Sept 6-7 SNSC "restricted zone" announcement remains not-yet-executed** — no new dated development, not re-scored a second time.
- ★ **BTC traded at \$79,052.40 on Sept 9** — up from \$78,435.62 on Sept 8 and \$79,090.41 on Sept 7 (data via the GitHub Actions fetch workflow).

Carried forward from Sept 8 (re-verified this cycle — still load-bearing):

- ★ **Iran SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei announced on-record, Sept 6-7, that Iran will declare a new "restricted zone" beyond the Strait of Hormuz "in the coming days."** The zone would be placed on Iran's sanctions list. Corroborated across 8+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, The Hill, RTE, Anadolu Agency, Newsbytes, WFLA/Nexstar, GlobalSecurity.org) in addition to CENTCOM's own press release.
- ★ **This is a threat of intent, not yet executed:** Al Jazeera's own Sept 7 explainer states "further details, including the precise boundaries, have yet to be announced." Rezaei separately said an IIRGC "restricted zone" is being considered. This research pass.
- ★ **GlobalSecurity's Day 192 (Sept 7) tracker puts the blockade count at 92 vessels redirected, 3 disabled, 2 boarded** — up from Day 190's 87/3/2 (Sept 3), a continuation of the already-priced.
- ★ **BTC traded at \$78,435.62 on Sept 8** — down from \$79,090.41 on Sept 7 and \$80,338.98 on Sept 6 (data via the GitHub Actions fetch workflow).

Carried forward from Sept 6 (re-verified this cycle — still load-bearing):

- ★ **CENTCOM's own on-the-record press release (centcom.mil) confirms US forces struck THREE Iranian crude oil tankers Sept 5, resolving the tanker report this pillar had withheld previously** (permanently disabled near Jask), and M/T Kylo (completely destroyed in the Gulf of Oman) — in retaliation for the IRGC firing ballistic missiles at two US Navy warships (an aircraft carrier and a destroyer) and personnel harmed. Corroborated by Al Arabiya, Jerusalem Post, CNN, NBC, and 5+ other independent outlets, in addition to CENTCOM's own release.
- ★ **This revealed a materially more serious escalation than the Sept 5 baseline knew:** not a quiet single-tanker interdiction, but a direct, unprovoked IRGC missile attack on US Navy vessels and personnel. "If we shoot at two of our ships, we will impose an even higher economic cost — taking out three of yours."
- ★ **Sept 6's IRGC claims of further strikes on three more tankers plus three "US-linked" vessels and a US naval drone** (Al Jazeera live blog, Euronews) remain US-unconfirmed as of this cycle.
- ★ **BTC traded at \$79,929.30 on Sept 6** — up from \$79,646.11 on Sept 5 (data via the GitHub Actions fetch workflow).

Carried forward from Sept 2 (re-verified through the Sept 5 full weekly refresh and this cycle — still load-bearing):

- ★ **CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes Sept 1-2 hit nearly 100 targets across Iran, roughly 50x the scale of the Aug 30 Larak Island strike.** Targets included IRGC air-defense sites, radar installations, and missile launchers. Multi-source corroborated: Axios, CNBC, CNN, Bloomberg, UPI.
- ★ ★ **NEW — for the first time in this war, the US struck Iranian government oil tankers directly (engine rooms), under a newly reported Trump-approved "tanker for tanker" policy** — to direct strikes on Iranian state vessels.

- ★ ★ **NEW** — **Brent rose ~5% Tuesday Sept 1, its best session in 5 weeks, to ~\$95-96.6/bbl; WTI to ~\$91-92** — still short of the \$100/bbl flip line.
- ★ ★ **NEW, FLAGGED SINGLE-NARRATIVE-SOURCED** — **a US strike on Kuestak, Sirik County, Hormozgan (near the Strait) reportedly hit a wedding party.** The Hormozgan governor's claim (via CBS News, Yahoo, UPI report the claim). CENTCOM's Cmdr. Tim Hawkins told CBS News the US has neither confirmed nor denied it. The casualty claim itself originates with Iranian state/local authorities, but is multi-sourced. Per the sufficiency rule, this claim alone does NOT move P; it is reported as context for the retaliation it triggered.
- ★ ★ **NEW** — **Iran's IRGC retaliated Sept 2 with coordinated ballistic-missile and drone strikes on US-linked bases in FOUR countries simultaneously: Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, and Kuwait** — strike Aug 30-31 — but all four are REPEAT targets already struck earlier in this war (Jordan: Jul 28, Aug 30-31; Bahrain/Kuwait/Iraq: struck at various points Feb-Jul 2026), so the "widening to" clause is not applicable.
- **NEW** — **most projectiles were intercepted:** Jordan (~10 of 25 intercepted, 3 landed, no reported casualties); Bahrain (most of roughly two dozen drones intercepted). No confirmed new US strikes, nor the widening clause independently fires.
- **NEW** — **both sides now on-record threatening larger future action:** President Trump threatened a "significantly larger response" if Iran retaliates further; an unnamed senior Iranian military official threatened continued escalation risk, not de-escalation.
- **BTC traded at \$76,581.44 on Sept 2** — down from \$78,038.78 on Sept 1 (Bitstamp), a real risk-off move.

Carried forward from the Sept 1 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-01_draft, now superseded — still load-bearing):

- ★ **A THIRD Hormuz tanker hit this week, Aug 31, CONFIRMED via UKMTO plus multi-source reporting.** The Liberian-flagged VLCC Senegal Prosperity was struck by three unknown projectiles on Aug 31, hitting the side, engine room, and ballast tank. No casualties, no environmental impact reported; UKMTO-logged. This follows the already-priced Metro Venetian (Aug 24) and Al Salam II (Aug 25) incidents.
- ★ **Iran's army claims a drone strike on the UAE's Al Minhad Air Base; the UAE Ministry of Defense DENIES that base was targeted while CONFIRMING a separate cross-border drone incident.** The UAE MoD explicitly denied Al Minhad was targeted, while separately confirming its air force intercepted an Iranian drone detected over UAE territorial waters, approaching from Iraq. Sources: CBS News, Al Jazeera, Breitbart, Yahoo, Jerusalem Post, ABC News, Seatrade Maritime, and Iran International.
- ★ **President Trump said on-record Aug 31 he is still weighing further strikes on Iran**, calling it "a relatively little war for us" (CBS News, Breitbart, Yahoo — on-record, multi-source) — explicitly not a decision.
- **Brent crude continued higher into Sept 1 (~+2% Tuesday per multiple market-desk reports)** on fresh-clash fears — the session after the long Labor Day weekend, the second straight cycle.
- **Jordan was struck again Aug 30-31**, but remained a repeat, not a "further new," state per this pillar's own framing (already struck Jul 28 and again as part of the Aug 30 IRGC retaliation) — not a widening.
- **BTC traded at \$78,038.78 on Sept 1** — down from \$78,447.16 on Aug 31 (Bitstamp).

Carried forward from the Aug 31 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-08-31_draft, now superseded — still load-bearing):

- ★ **Resumed direct US strike on Iranian territory, Aug 30, CONFIRMED via on-record CENTCOM spokesperson plus 20+ independent outlets.** US forces struck two IRGC rocket/mine-launchers on Aug 30, hitting the Strait of Hormuz — into the strait — Capt. Tim Hawkins (CENTCOM) confirmed on the record; corroborated by Bloomberg, CNBC, NBC News, Reuters, Newsweek, ABC News, Al Jazeera, Fox News, RFE/RL, Epoch, and others. This is the first direct US strike on Iranian territory since Jul 29, ending the ~28-30-consecutive-clean-night streak. **Directly fired this pillar's own pre-declared flip line** ("a resumption of direct US strikes on Iran") — not a widening.
- ★ **IRGC retaliatory ballistic-missile strikes on two US-linked Jordan airbases, Aug 30-31, CONFIRMED via Jordan's own military statement plus multi-source reporting.** IRGC said it struck two US-linked airbases on Aug 30-31, hitting the bases — intercepted 8 missiles; Iran claims "heavy damage" to base infrastructure, unconfirmed by the US or Jordan beyond the interception — logged as Iran-sourced, not scored as fact. IRGC separately confirmed the strikes.
- **Press (Reuters/CNBC) framed the renewed exchange as weighing on Asian equities and US futures**, reversing the prior two-week Brent decline.
- **BTC traded at \$78,447.16 on Aug 31** — up from \$77,666.16 on Aug 29 (Bitstamp).

Carried forward from the Aug 29 full weekly refresh (score set 2026-08-29_draft, now superseded — still load-bearing):

- ★ **"Operation Economic Outcast" sanctions package, Aug 24, CONFIRMED via direct fetch of home.treasury.gov.** Press releases sb0613 ("Treasury Launches Unprecedented Campaign Against Iran's Economic Interests") — recent-actions entry dated 20260824 — corroborated by state.gov and 3+ independent trade-compliance/crypto-intelligence outlets (TRM Labs, Chainalysis, CryptoTimes) plus law-firm client reports from Singapore, and Switzerland under five EO 13902 sectoral determinations. **For the first time, digital assets was explicitly named as a sanctionable sector** — 30 crypto addresses across Bitcoin, Ethereum, and others. Rhetoric, this is real, primary-confirmed, and directly crypto-relevant. Continued Aug 28 with a new Bank Melli-Dubai designation.
- ★ ★ **NEW** — **Oman's OWN Foreign Ministry co-confirmed a temporary Hormuz corridor, Aug 25, CONFIRMED via direct fetch of fm.gov.om/en/53722.** A genuine upgrade: in every prior cycle, the US and Oman ministry co-hosts the joint statement. Terms: a temporary 7-mile-wide joint navigational corridor (entry/exit through Iranian waters), a joint mine-clearing project, and continuing technical talks. "temporary" — Iran itself said Aug 26 the Strait "remains closed" pending US compliance with the lapsed June MoU. No public fee/revenue terms were disclosed; a separate IRGC spokesman said Oman — correctly excluded.
- **NEW** — **two more Hormuz "unknown projectile" tanker incidents.** Aug 24, off Oman's coast (engine-room damage, vessel disabled, no casualties, UKMTO); Aug 27 (fire onboard, extinguished, no casualties, UKMTO).
- **NEW** — **CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper's on-record briefing, Aug 28** (corroborated by UPI, The National, Washington Times, The Hill, RedState, IranWire): US forces cleared Iran's waters of ~1,500 commercial vessels have transited since blockade enforcement began; ~75 vessels turned back and 3 disabled for evading the blockade; no oil has been exported from Iran since the blockade began; US forces cleared Iran's waters of ~1,500 commercial vessels have transited since blockade enforcement began; ~75 vessels turned back and 3 disabled for evading the blockade; no oil has been exported from Iran since the blockade began.
- **NEW** — **IMO's six-month casualty count (Aug 28, quasi-primary IMO briefing, corroborated by 4 outlets) settles at 19-20 dead** (seafarers + port workers) across 68-70 incidents — the highest toll in the history of the Strait of Hormuz.
- **NEW** — **Trump declared the Strait "demined" Aug 25** with a "zero tolerance" policy on new mines (Reuters, Axios, France24, US News) — undercut two days later by the Aug 27 tanker attack.
- **NEW** — **the first quantified Hormuz transit-volume increase of the whole crisis: +30%+ week-over-week for the week of Aug 17-23** (USNI News, citing Lloyd's List Intelligence — quantified the week prior week (westbound 29→42). Still a small fraction (~10-15%) of the ~110-130/day (~770-910/week) pre-war baseline, but a genuine first uptick.
- **NEW** — **Brent eased for a SECOND straight week:** ~\$88.24 (Aug 25) → ~\$89.13-89.3 (Aug 27, weekly loss >5%) → ~\$88.29-90.55 (Aug 28) — down from ~\$93-95 (Aug 20-21), moving further from the Aug 20-21 Hormuz progress.
- **NEW** — **no new confirmed US combat death Aug 22-29** (checked directly — one initial-looking hit, Sgt. Michael Emmanuel Swinton, was actually killed Jul 18-19, already counted in the statistics).
- **NEW** — **no new US/CENTCOM strikes on Iran found** — GlobalSecurity's Day-181 tracker (checked Aug 27) confirms a 28th consecutive night with no confirmed strike.
- **BTC closed at \$77,666.16 on Aug 29** — up modestly from \$77,266.84 on Aug 22 (Bitstamp).

Carried forward from the abandoned Aug 28 draft (2026-08-28_draft — never rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed; re-confirmed independently this cycle, not taken on faith): the two Aug 24/Aug 27 tanker incidents and Tim Cooper's claim was also first flagged there as not-used. All re-verified fresh this cycle.

Carried forward from the Aug 22 full weekly refresh (score set 2026-08-22_draft2, committed by Alex Aug 23 — still load-bearing):

- ★ **Casualty toll (as of Aug 22): real, but a range, not a point figure.** That cycle cross-checked the cumulative Hormuz-campaign death toll directly: Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" page (last updated Aug 22) shows at least 15; IMO's own "Middle East Highlighted Incidents" page (fetched directly) shows 19 seafarer fatalities across 68 incidents as of Aug 21, but appears to aggregate the broader Middle East conflict (including Jazeera), not the Hormuz campaign cleanly. Honest range: **15-19 cumulative deaths, 17-18 by the most Hormuz-specific trackers** — now settled higher by this cycle's IMO six-month count.
- **No new kinetic incident found Aug 19-22.** Independent re-checking for vessel strikes, seizures, or Iran-related military incidents in that window found nothing beyond the Aug 22 draft baseline.
- **The UAE missile-attack claim reconciles to the same known Aug 18 episode, not a new one.** Aug 19-dated reporting (Washington Post, NBC News, Haaretz, The Week, EgyptToday) described a missile attack on a UAE ship, flagged as a possible miss; on reconciliation it is the same episode already in the draft baseline (CBS/CNN/AI Jazeera, Aug 18 strike / Aug 19 embargo response) — a one-day cross-outlet data discrepancy, not a possible "false flag" — genuinely disputed, both sides single-source on their own claims.
- **CENTCOM's blockade/interdiction tally was climbing incrementally as of Aug 22** (68 vessels redirected vs. ~67 shortly before) — now superseded by this cycle's Aug 28 briefing above.

- From the Aug 22 morning draft (score set 2026-08-22_draft) — carried forward, casualty framing softened above:*

- Carried forward from Aug 18-20 (still load-bearing — the UAE "novel escalation" framing is corrected above, not repeated here):*

- Carried forward from Aug 16-18 (independently re-verified against fresh primary sources this cycle — all confirmed accurate, still load-bearing).*

- Carried forward from Aug 14-16 (still load-bearing):*

- Carried forward from Aug 11-14 (still load-bearing):

- Carried forward from Aug 8-10 (still load-bearing):

- Carried forward from Aug 1-8 (still load-bearing):

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- ★ **★ NEW — a new front: Iran-backed Houthi forces struck Najran, Saudi Arabia on Aug 7**, wounding 11 civilians (7 Saudi, 1 Yemeni, 2 Egyptian, 1 Pakistani, including a 4-year-old with burns) in the "southern Middle East" (Al Jazeera, Japan Times, OIC statement corroborate).
- ★ **★ NEW — Saudi Arabia, Turkey, and Pakistan signed a mutual-defense "Mecca" pact on Aug 7** (an attack on one is an attack on all) — a structural, deterrence-oriented development that could push the conflict further into the conflict.
- **Aug 7-8 — Iran announced what it calls a finalized agreement with Oman on Hormuz shipping**, banning American and Israeli vessels and fining violators up to 20% of cargo value (IRNA rejected these terms (NPR, Al Jazeera), insisting on zero tolls, permits, or approvals. The fundamental fee/sovereignty dispute is unresolved, not narrowed. This claim's specific draft terms trace back to 2019, not independently verified.
- **Correction: Trump's Aug 2 "perimeters of a deal" framing was contested by his own later remarks.** Two days after claiming "the perimeters of a deal has been agreed to," Trump called it "a mere treat the Aug 2 claim as rhetoric outpacing substance, a pattern that recurred all week (positive announcements paired with continuing attacks or contradictions within 1-2 days each time).
- **Brent held a \$82-86/bbl range through the week** — up modestly, not pricing a resolved crisis.
- **BTC closed at \$65,006.64 on Aug 8** — essentially flat vs. Aug 7's close of \$65,000.00.

Carried forward from Aug 1-7 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Aug 7 — the Iran-Oman joint statement remained unsigned as of that check, still in final drafting.** Iran's Foreign Ministry spokesman Baghaei described the statement outlining agreed-upon "a process."

Carried forward from Aug 1-6 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Aug 6 — Iran and Oman reached an "understanding in principle" on the Hormuz route map.** Iran's Deputy Foreign Minister Kazem Gharibabadi told IRNA: "an understanding in principle on the perimeters of a deal and exit routes" — confirmed by Bloomberg (two articles), CBS, Al Jazeera (two articles), Euronews, and Military.com.
- ★ **Aug 6 — the fee dispute first surfaced as the remaining obstacle.** Iran is seeking fees of 5-7% of cargo value from transiting ships; Oman is discussing fees around 3%; Washington wants to separately reports sources saying the proposed passage deal is "not feasible for shipping industry."

Carried forward from Aug 1-5 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Aug 1 — the first quiet night in days.** globalsecurity.org's day-by-day war tracker reported no new US strikes on Iran overnight Jul 31 following the heavy Jul 29-30 wave; Brent fell ~2% on the day; shipping protection was reported drawing backing from 14 countries.
- ★ **Aug 1-2 — fresh, multi-source-corroborated attacks on Hormuz shipping.** Bloomberg: a Qatari LNG tanker (Gaslog Shanghai) was struck while transiting the Strait. UKMTO/globalsecurity.org: the engine room damaged and the vessel disabled. These directly contradicted the Aug 1 "quiet night" framing — the pause was not durable.
- **Aug 2 — the Saudi-led naval coalition kept solidifying.** Al Jazeera, The National, DefenseMirror, and Tribune reported 14 confirmed member countries and 43 nations represented at a first meeting, distinct from any single day's attack-or-lull headline.
- ★ **Aug 4 — Trump canceled a planned joint US-Israeli strike on Iranian energy infrastructure.** Multiple outlets (NPR, Axios, Al Jazeera, NBC, Washington Times, Breitbart, JPost, Townhall, CNN) reported the 1-2 weekend, reportedly including a full Strait of Hormuz reopening. No US strikes on Iran proper have been reported since the cancellation.
- **Aug 4 — Iran continues to deny any direct US talks.** Foreign Ministry spokesman Baghaei: "we currently have no negotiations with the United States; the negotiations are with Oman." Trump: "I'm not talking about Iran."
- ★ **Aug 4 — a bulker was struck by a projectile and suffered a full blackout in the Strait** (globalsecurity.org, iransitrep.com) — active attacks continued even as the diplomatic framework was being built.
- ★ **Aug 5 — the first public terms of a 60-day interim Hormuz deal.** Axios, Deccan Chronicle, Israel Hayom, InvestingLive, The National, and Al-Quds report the US, Iran, and Oman nearing an agreement on the median lane in Omani waters, no tolls or transit fees during the interim period, and a plan to clear naval mines from the median lane within 30 days. The US aimed to announce the deal Aug 6.
- **Aug 5 — still unsigned.** CNN quotes a Gulf official putting the odds of an Iran-Oman deal by Friday at only 50-50. The Strait remains formally impassable to normal traffic pending finalization of a deal.
- **BTC closed at \$64,661.55 on Aug 5** — up ~1.7% from the \$63,579.68 close on Jul 31, continuing its resilience through a week where the war's own risk signal moved both up and down.

Carried forward from the July 30 full refresh (still load-bearing):

- ★ **The lull was real, then it broke: Iran's IRGC struck a US/CENTCOM base at Muwaffaq Salti, Jordan (Jul 28).** Confirmed by 5+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, CNN, Axios, RT, JPost) — breaking the 2-day lull, but no US casualties. This came after a genuine 2-3 day pause in CENTCOM strikes (Jul 25-27) and on the same day Trump was publicly touting "very friendly" talks with Netanyahu at the White House.
- ★ **The US retaliated with a "heavy wave of strikes" (Jul 29)** — explosions reported at Bandar Abbas, Kish Island, Qeshm Island, and Khuzestan Province (CNN). Trump: "it's our turn to hit them where they live." The war pulls in more countries."
- ★ **NEW FRONT — Iraq: US and Saudi Arabia conducted joint strikes on Iran-backed Popular Mobilisation Forces across Iraq (Jul 29),** CENTCOM-confirmed, hitting sites in Baghdad, Wasit, and Tikrit (BBC, Foreign Policy, 5+ outlets). Iraq's government called it a "flagrant violation of sovereignty." This is Saudi Arabia's first turn as a direct co-belligerent in this war. A claim that "six Iranian IRGC advisors were killed" remains unconfirmed.
- ★ **NEW FRONT — Egypt: a drone hit a US-owned FSRU vessel and a tanker at Egypt's Damietta port (Jul 29)** — the first strike on Egyptian soil in this war (Al Jazeera, CNBC, Times of Israel). Attribution remains unresolved.
- **Brent rebounded from the lull-low.** Brent fell to ~\$90/bbl (-6.7%) during the Jul 25-27 lull, then rose back to ~\$92-93/bbl by Jul 30 (+~3.5% day-over-day, +24.6% month-over-month) on the day of the heavy strikes. The lull-low may not be corroborated and is dropped from this report.
- **Iran continues rejecting a direct-talks framing even as Trump claims progress.** Iran FM spokesman Baghaei, Jul 27: "We have no negotiations with the United States at present" — directly contradicting Trump's claim. A claim that "six Iranian IRGC advisors were killed" remains unconfirmed. (Qatar/Egypt/Oman/Pakistan) remains on the table, unaccepted; Iran separately rejected an Oman joint-Hormuz-management proposal on Jul 28, insisting on controlling its own lane.
- **Congress split on competing War Powers resolutions (Jul 23, carried forward, no new action since):** House passed a nonbinding one 214-208 (4 GOP defectors); the Senate's binding one 68-32 remains pending.
- ★ **The Pentagon casualty-count dispute (18 vs. 14) is confirmed stale, not a fresh Jul 30 event.** The DCAS toll briefly rose to 18 (Jul 23) then reverted to 14 (Jul 24) amid a credibly-sourced report that the War Powers clock. This is the same dispute already logged last cycle — one daily touch this week re-cited the Jul 24 CNBC article as if it were new; it is not.
- **Strait of Hormuz remains effectively closed to normal commercial traffic** — ~10 transits/day versus a normal baseline near 88/day (IMF PortWatch), unchanged from prior cycles. IRGC, JPost, and others report the Strait remains closed.
- **No formal MoU withdrawal by either side.** The 60-day window to ~Aug 16 remains intact and un-triggered.
- **Israel remains out of direct engagement** — no confirmed direct Israel-Iran exchange since June 7-8; the widened fronts (Iraq, Egypt) involve the US, Saudi Arabia, and unclaimed actors, not Israel.
- **The "Layla" tanker claim (Jul 23) remains unconfirmed** after a full week — AIS data dark, no primary confirmation found. Downgraded from "watch" to "discard pending new evidence."
- **The baseline (still true, still load-bearing):** June 2025 "12-Day War" — BTC dipped to a ~\$98,225 intraday low, reclaimed \$107k+ within days, a fast V. The far larger 2026 war still hasn't crossed the threshold to spread to two new countries this week.

The Prize

Illustrative only — not price targets, not advice

The upside is still the **"buy-the-invasion" rebound**. Anchors: Russia–Ukraine (Feb 24, 2022) — BTC fell ~8% to a **~\$34,300 intraday low**, posted a +14.5% up-day on Feb 28, ended **~+25-28%** fully recovered within a week.

The Aug 30-31 direct US-Iran exchange has now escalated sharply further: a ~50x-larger US strike wave, the war's first direct strikes on Iranian government tankers, and a four-country Iranian pillar had been building since Aug 25 (Oman's own government confirming a temporary Hormuz corridor). That corridor claim is still technically on the table, unretracted, but a fresh, much-larger dip-buy thesis is now down at all right now. BTC traded at **\$76,581.44** on Sept 2, down from Sept 1's \$78,038.78 — a real, visible risk-off move that for once tracks the same direction as this pillar's own evidence. This is the best scoring evidence — this report scores the war's facts, not the market's reaction to them. The upside case is unchanged in shape: a fee/compensation/sovereignty compromise both sides actually accept would shift the prize from "temporary corridor" to "a full corridor reopens and the risk premium unwinds for real." That's now considerably further away than it was even yesterday, not closer.

The Other Side

The strongest honest case this is wrong

- **The cut may still be too small, even at 1/9/27/47/74.** Nearly 100 targets, the war's first direct tanker strikes, and a four-country simultaneous retaliation is a genuinely different order of magnitude from front-end windows (1mo, now at P=1, barely above the floor) understate just how close this now sits to the worst-case scenario this pillar has always flagged as the real tail risk, and that keeping the current incidents, is itself a mistake when the underlying event is this much larger.
- **Leaving it as a draft may itself be too cautious.** The independently-confirmed facts alone — CENTCOM's own ~100-target count, the first-ever tanker strikes, the four-country retaliation, and the fact that the US is justified in justify this cut without leaning on the wedding-strike claim at all; a reader could argue this pillar is using the single-source caveat as an excuse to soften a call the non-disputed facts already suggest.
- **The cut may be too small.** This report explicitly pre-declared "a resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper" as the line that breaks the dip-buy thesis — and calibrated the actual cut to a level of standing, pre-committed warning line. A stricter reader could argue firing your own flip line warrants a materially larger cut than a routine tanker incident, precisely because the report itself says it's a warning line.
- **The cut may be too large.** One resumed-strike night after ~28-30 clean nights is, so far, a single interdiction event (stopping a mine-laying attempt) rather than evidence of a full campaign of escalation, but it's equally possible this is a contained, one-off enforcement action that doesn't repeat. If no further strikes follow in the next few days, this cut may prove to have moved faster than the underlying event.
- **The Oman corridor confirmation (Aug 25) is not retracted.** Oman's own Foreign Ministry still has not walked back its Aug 25 joint statement — the first time both parties on the "deal" side of the structural fact, and a reader could argue the 1yr/3yr windows are being cut too by association with a fundamentally 1mo/3mo-scoped shock.
- **The Aug 24 sanctions package is arguably a bigger structural story than this week's kinetic exchange.** It was the first Iran sanctions action in this war to explicitly name digital assets as a target, a category this pillar has never faced before, and one that doesn't fade if the current strike cycle cools.
- **No confirmed US casualty, still.** The single hardest-edged clause of this pillar's own flip line — a confirmed new US combat death — remains unfired even after this week's exchange; a reader could argue the strikes-resumed clause alone.
- **Thin sample, still.** The bullish long-term read rests on a handful of dip-and-recover events, all in a bull regime — geopolitical shocks don't always V-recover, and a fresh direct strike exchange could trigger cuts of similar or larger size.
- **Two more restraint signals landed this cycle, logged honestly — a reader could argue they're under-weighted.** The BRICS New Delhi summit's joint declaration (Sept 12) — signed by S. P. "maximum restraint" and voiced concern over attacks on civilian and nuclear infrastructure, and Trump's own account describes the Houthis privately signaling they don't want direct US involvement (substance), but this pillar logs every new strike within a day while diplomatic restraint signals like these get folded in as a line, not a re-rate — a stricter reader could argue that asymmetry itself.

The Triggers

*Dated events ahead — some prove the claim right, some prove it wrong. Re-leveled August 22, 2026, refreshed August 29; **this pillar's own downside flip line FIRED August 30** (see the flip-line box below) — a resumption of direct escalation continued sharply Sept 1-2 — a materially larger strike wave and a four-country retaliation; the Sept 5 tanker strike is CENTCOM-CONFIRMED and revealed to be part of a direct IRGC missile attack on 2 US Navy warships, yet executed; CENTCOM confirms a FIVE-tanker strike Sept 8, and Brent crosses \$100 intraday Sept 9 for the first time since July 24; the IRGC retaliates for that strike by hitting Jordan's Al Azraq air base Sept 9, and Houthi forces seize a Red Sea oil tanker Sept 9; **clause has now fired** — the "sustained Brent close above \$100" clause, on a third consecutive session above \$100 including a close above \$107 on Sept 10. **By Sept 11-12, Houthi forces completed their sweep of Yemen's Red Sea** "closing in on" to actual island-level control, though it does not independently fire a fresh flip-line clause (top row). **As of the Sept 13 light daily touch, the first de-escalation datapoint in six weeks landed: Iran's foreign minister in Salalah, Oman on Monday Sept 14 on Strait of Hormuz navigation, safe shipping routes and mine clearance — the first such gathering since the war began in February (Iranian MFA statement, primary, plus 6+ Bahrain's announced non-attendance, an Iranian official's statement that no deal is expected, the fact that the agenda concerns managing a strait Iran still controls, and continued fighting on Sept 13 (a fatal vessel NOT fire the upside flip line, which requires a signed, US-accepted Hormuz reopening holding a full clean week. In the prior Sept 12 full weekly refresh, a third distinct Saudi oil-infrastructure strike landed — drone Sept 11), sponsorship undetermined (Trump's "probably Iran" is a single hedged remark) — neither the widening clause (Iraq is existing theater) nor the US-casualty clause fires.***

DATE	EVENT
FIRED Sept 13 — PRIMARY (Oman News Agency statement) plus 5+ independent outlets (Arab News, Washington Post, CNN, Gulf News, Malay Mail)	The Salalah ministerial was POSTPONED, one day before it was to convene, with NO new date. ONA: the meeting is "postponed to a later date ... in order to create conditions conducive to a constructive dialogue." Bahrain had explicitly ruled out attending; no GCC state had confirmed; the UAE had downgraded to minister of state. Iran's MFA says Saudi Arabia requested the delay citing Yemen and calls that a pretext — <i>single-party-sourced to Iranian officials, reported not scored.</i> Separately, FM Araqchi said the Iran-Oman understanding "would not mean reopening of the Strait of Hormuz" (Tehran Times/Mehr). Brent +2.8% past WTI \$102.34 — <i>market prices, reported not scored.</i>
Announced Fri Sept 11, reported Sept 11-12 — PRIMARY (Iranian MFA statement) plus 6+ independent outlets; SUPERSEDED — the meeting was postponed Sept 13, see the row above	First Iran-GCC ministerial meeting since the war began in February. The foreign ministers of Iran, the six GCC states and Iraq convene in Salalah, Oman to discuss Strait of Hormuz navigation — safe/temporary commercial shipping routes, mine clearance and short-term management of the waterway, built on weeks of Oman-mediated Iran-Oman talks. Iranian MFA: the gathering aims "to promote better understanding among the countries of the region and help strengthen regional security" (Al Jazeera Sept 11, Dawn Sept 12, Arab News, Oman Observer, The Business Standard, Business Recorder, ARMENPRESS, SBS). Logged counterweights: Bahrain announced Sept 12 it will not attend; an Iranian official told JPost no signed deal is expected; Tehran is weighing a transit service-free regime, i.e. the agenda is about managing a strait Iran still controls
Sept 13, reported same day (Al Jazeera live blog) — Iran's attribution is Iran's own and is NOT treated as established	A commercial vessel was attacked near Qeshm Island inside the Strait of Hormuz, killing one and wounding four; an Iranian official blamed the "US terrorist effort." A Houthi projectile struck Jazan, Saudi Arabia, causing injuries and damaging a mosque. Houthi forces and Yemen's internationally recognised government continued trading strikes over Bab al-Mandeb
Friday Sept 11 — a market price, reported NOT used to move P	Brent gave back 4.24% to ~\$104.26, the first meaningful downside session since the sustained->\$100 flip-line clause fired; wire coverage attributes it to the Houthi diplomacy plus the IEA's demand-contraction forecast (TradingEconomics, Forbes)
Attack Sept 10, Saudi MFA statement/confirmation Sept 11 (primary) plus 6+ independent outlets — sponsorship UNDETERMINED (Iraqi-origin, no group claim)	Saudi Arabia's East-West Pipeline (Petroline) — its primary Hormuz-bypass oil-export route — hit by drones launched from Iraqi territory; Saudi MFA confirms pumping stations near Riyadh/Medina struck, injuries and material damage, will not retaliate for now at Baghdad's request (Al Jazeera, CNN, Times of Israel, ABC News Australia, OilPrice.com). Iraq's PM ordered a probe, dismissed the Maysan operations commander, closed the Shalamcheh border crossing. Trump (Dublin): Iran "probably" responsible — single, hedged, unconfirmed, NOT treated as fact
Fired Sept 10-11, escalated to island seizure Sept 11, CONFIRMED via 6+ independent outlets — no strait closure yet	Houthi forces complete their sweep of Yemen's entire Red Sea coastline (capturing Dhubab, Murad) and seize Mayyun (Perim) Island in the Bab al-Mandeb strait; fighting continues for Zuqar Island (Al Jazeera, NBC News, CNBC, NPR, The National, National Herald). Saudi Crown Prince MBS's request for direct US strikes on the Houthis was refused (intel/targeting support offered instead)
Sept 10 (UKMTO Warning 133-26, issued 1910 UTC), reported Sept 11 — CONFIRMED via UKMTO plus 3+ independent outlets	Four unidentified projectiles struck two vessels ~4nm west of Khasab, Oman, setting one afire (UKMTO; Gulf News, Maritime Executive, The Hill corroborating). Logged, not used to move P (single-source, IRGC claim only): a separate IRGC claim of a strike on a US Navy Saildrone near the Strait entrance without US/CENTCOM confirmation
FIRED Sept 10-11 — a flip-line clause, CONFIRMED via 4+ independent market sources	"Sustained Brent close above \$100" — Brent ended Thursday Sept 10 up more than 6% above \$107 (above \$108 intraday), its highest since May 19; closed above \$102 for the first time since May; Brent still ~\$104.36 midday Friday Sept 11, ~9% higher on the week (Rigzone/Bloomberg wire, TradingEconomics, Vantage Markets, NAI500). Three consecutive sessions above \$100. <i>Correction:</i> the Sept 10 cycle logged ~\$101.25 as that Thursday's level - intraday read, not the close
Fired Sept 9, fuller reporting landed Sept 10-11, CONFIRMED via 4 independent outlets (Reuters wire)	Iran attacked 10 vessels near the Strait of Hormuz — 2 US-linked ships and 8 oil tankers — the largest declared wave of shipping attacks by either side since the war began; at least one seafarer killed, one missing (Reuters via U.S. News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill)
Fired Sept 9, CONFIRMED via CENTCOM/Jordan's own military statement plus multi-outlet reporting	IRGC retaliates for the Sept 8 five-tanker strike by firing 20 ballistic missiles at Jordan's Al Azraq (Muwaffaq Salti) air base — Jordan's armed forces said no missiles were intercepted, 2 fell in unpopulated areas, no casualties (Al Jazeera, MiGFlug, GlobalSecurity.org Day 194, Jordan's own military statement)
Fired Sept 10, CONFIRMED via 5+ independent outlets — chokepoint NOT yet closed	Iran-aligned Houthi forces seize the Yemeni Red Sea port city of Mocha, closing in on control of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait — a SECOND global shipping chokepoint distinct from Hormuz (The Media Line, Times of Israel, Al Jazeera, South China Morning Post, Jerusalem Post, Cyprus Mail)
Second straight session, logged Sept 10 — SUPERSEDED by the Sept 10-11 firing above	Brent crude trades near/above \$100/bbl for a second straight session — above \$101 Wednesday Sept 9 for the first time since May; the Sept 10 cycle logged ~\$101.25 as Thursday's level, which proved to be an intraday read (Thursday closed above \$107)
Crossed intraday Sept 9, CONFIRMED via CNBC and ABC News — NOT a sustained close	Brent crude tops \$100/bbl intraday for the first time since July 24 , trading ~\$100.44 (+2.57%) as U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strikes stoke oil-supply worries (CNBC, ABC News) "Brent crude tops \$100 as U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strikes stoke oil supply worries," ABC News)
Fired Sept 8, CONFIRMED via CENTCOM's own press release plus 5+ independent outlets	CENTCOM confirms US forces destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers Sept 8 — M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco (Gulf of Oman), and M/T Derya (Kharg Island) — after the IRGC targeted a US Navy warship with ballistic missiles TWICE over the preceding two days ("US Destroys 5 IRGC Tankers After Iran Targets Another American Warship," centcom.mil; NBC News, CBS News, SBS, RedState, GlobalSecurity.org corroborating)
Announced Sept 6-7, on-record, corroborated by 8+ independent outlets — NOT yet executed	Iran SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei announces Iran will declare a new "restricted zone" beginning at the US Navy's blockade line and extending into the Persian Gulf "in the coming days," with any vessel entering it placed on Iran's sanctions list; he separately says an Iran-Oman corridor agreement will be signed "in the coming days" (Press TV, Tehran Times, Al Jazeera, The Hill, RTE, Anadolu, Newsbytes, WFLA, GlobalSecurity.org)
Fired Sept 5, CONFIRMED Sept 6 via CENTCOM's own press release plus 5+ independent outlets	CENTCOM confirms US forces struck THREE Iranian crude oil tankers Sept 5 — M/T Downy (disabled, Kharg Island), M/T Stark 1 (disabled, Jask), M/T (destroyed, Gulf of Oman) — in retaliation for the IRGC firing ballistic missiles at two US Navy warships (a carrier and a guided-missile destroyer), both

	which evaded; no US personnel harmed (centcom.mil; Al Arabiya, Jerusalem Post, CNN, NBC corroborating)
Claimed Sept 6, single-source (IRGC) — NOT independently used to move P	Iran's IRGC claims further strikes on three more tankers plus three "US-linked" vessels, and a strike on a US naval drone entering the Strait of Hormuz (Jazeera live blog, Euronews)
Fired Sept 3, CONFIRMED — repeat targets, widening clause did NOT fire	Iran fired a second retaliatory wave on Ahmed al-Jaber AB (Kuwait) and Al Minhad AB (UAE) — a US official confirmed no US-manned facility was hit and third night of launches followed
Fired Sept 1-2, CONFIRMED via 9 independent outlets	CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes hit nearly 100 targets across Iran — IRGC air-defense sites, radar, mine-laying capability, comms sites, anti-ship cruise-missile/drone launchers — roughly 50x the scale of the Aug 30 Larak strike (Axios, CNBC, CNN, Bloomberg, UPI)
Fired Sept 1-2, CONFIRMED, novel	For the first time in this war, the US struck Iranian government oil tankers directly (engine rooms) under a newly reported "tanker for tanker" policy
Reported Sept 1-2, SINGLE-NARRATIVE-SOURCED at the core fact — NOT independently used to move P	A US strike on Kuhestak, Hormozgan reportedly hit a wedding party — Hormozgan governor's office: 4 of at least 5 dead (incl. a 4-year-old), 60+ injured; CENTCOM has neither confirmed nor denied it
Fired Sept 2, CONFIRMED via multi-source reporting — widening clause did NOT fire	IRGC coordinated ballistic-missile/drone strikes on US-linked bases in FOUR countries at once: Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait — most projectiles intercepted; no confirmed new US combat death
Fired Aug 31, CONFIRMED via UKMTO plus multi-source reporting	A THIRD Hormuz tanker hit this week: the Liberian-flagged VLCC Senegal Prosperity struck by three unknown projectiles ~17nm northeast of Khasab, Oman (side, engine room, ballast tank), no casualties — follows the already-priced Metro Venetian (Aug 24) and Al Salam II (Aug 25)
Claimed Aug 31, DISPUTED target / CONFIRMED incursion	Iran's army claims a drone strike on the UAE's Al Minhad Air Base; UAE MoD DENIES the base was targeted while CONFIRMING it intercepted an Iranian drone over its territorial waters
Fired Aug 31, on-record — not a de-escalation signal	President Trump said on-record he is still weighing further strikes on Iran , calling it "a relatively little war for us" (CBS News, Breitbart, Yahoo)
Fired Aug 30, CONFIRMED — FLIP LINE TRIGGERED	Resumption of direct US strikes on Iranian territory: CENTCOM struck two IRGC rocket/mine-launchers on Larak Island after observing prep to fire sea mines in the Strait — first US strike on Iran since Jul 29, ending the ~28-30-night clean streak; corroborated by 20+ outlets plus on-record CENTCOM spokesperson Caitlin Hawkins
Fired Aug 30-31, CONFIRMED (Iran-claimed damage NOT independently confirmed)	IRGC retaliatory ballistic-missile strikes on two US-linked Jordan airbases (King Hussein, Al-Azraq) — Jordan's military intercepted 8 missiles; Iran claims "no damage," unconfirmed by US/Jordan beyond interception; no confirmed US casualty
Fired Aug 24, CONFIRMED via direct fetch — re-verified Aug 29	"Operation Economic Outcast" sanctions package — home.treasury.gov sb0613/sb0614, OFAC recent-actions entry 20260824; ~60 entities/individuals/vessels designated under five EO 13902 sectoral determinations; FIRST TIME digital assets named a sanctionable sector, 30 crypto addresses (BTC/ETH/TRON) listed; corroborated by state.gov, TRM Labs, Chainalysis, CryptoTimes, law-firm alerts; continued Aug 28 with a Bank Melli-Dubai designation
Fired Aug 25, CONFIRMED via direct fetch — re-verified Aug 29	Oman's OWN Foreign Ministry co-confirmed a temporary Hormuz corridor — fm.gov.om/en/53722; 7-mile joint navigational corridor (entry/exit through Iranian waters), joint mine-clearing project, continuing talks toward a permanent corridor per the "Islamabad Memorandum"; still explicitly "temporary," no fees disclosed; Iran itself said Aug 26 the Strait "remains closed" pending US compliance
Fired Aug 24 & Aug 27, re-verified Aug 29	Two more Hormuz "unknown projectile" tanker incidents: Aug 24, off Oman's coast, engine-room damage, vessel disabled, no casualties (UKMTO); Aug 27, onboard, extinguished same-day, crew safe (UKMTO). Neither incident's attribution confirmed by any party.
Fired Aug 25, re-verified Aug 29 — real but NOT durable	Trump announced the Strait of Hormuz "has been demined" and declared a "zero tolerance" policy on new mines, backed by Space Force surveillance (Reuters, Axios, France24, US News, multiple corroborating) — the Aug 27 tanker incident above landed two days later, undercutting durability
Aug 28, CONFIRMED — re-verified Aug 29	CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper's on-record briefing: Iranian sea mines cleared from the internationally-recognized shipping lanes; ~1,500 vessels transited since blockade enforcement began; ~75 turned back, 3 disabled for evasion; no Iranian oil exports since blockade resumed (UPI, The National, Washington Times, The Hill, RedState, IranWire)
Aug 28 IMO briefing, quasi-primary, corroborated by 4 outlets	Six-month casualty count settles at 19-20 dead across 68-70 incidents — the upper end of the previously-reported 15-19 range
Week of Aug 17-23, reported Aug 21 & Aug 28 (USNI News/Lloyd's List)	First confirmed Hormuz transit-volume uptick of the whole crisis: +30%+ week-over-week, 114 transits vs. 87 the prior week (westbound 29→42) — still ~15% of the pre-war baseline
Claimed Aug 26, single-source, NOT USED — re-checked Aug 29	IRGC spokesman claims Iran and Oman agreed to share Hormuz revenue and delineate waters (Sepah News, Iranian state military source; via Bloomberg, Yahoo Finance, Insurance Journal) — but Oman's own Foreign Ministry did NOT confirm it, the two countries' own joint statement described only an "interim framework" with no mention of fees, and the IRGC's own spokesman said the US is "obstructing this process"
Checked Aug 27 — GlobalSecurity Day-181 tracker	28th consecutive night with no confirmed US/CENTCOM strike on Iran
Checked directly Aug 22-29 — no new event	No new confirmed US combat death. One initial-looking hit (Sgt. Michael Emmanuel Swinton) was actually killed Jul 18-19, already counted in the standing tally of not new
Fired Aug 17-18 — CONFIRMED, negative, but CORRECTED framing, toll RE-VERIFIED as a range	Fatal strike in the tanker-attack campaign: bulker Minoan Dignity struck, chief engineer killed

Fired Aug 17, held to Aug 19 — CONFIRMED, negative, cleared the bar	First Iranian vessel seizure since June 22: tanker Amara boarded near Qeshm Island, held under Iran's post-MoU toll regime
Fired Aug 18 — CONFIRMED reported, DISPUTED attribution, single-source; RECONCILED this cycle	The UAE reports Iran fired two ballistic missiles at its territory , one landing in territorial waters; Iran denies involvement, calls it a possible "false flag"
Announced Aug 19 — CONFIRMED, negative, structural	The UAE suspended all trade, commercial, and financial dealings with Iran
Reported Aug 20, still unsigned as of Aug 22 draft2 — continuation, not yet resolved	The Iran-Oman Hormuz route deal remains unsigned ; Iran claims coordinates agreed Aug 18, Oman has not confirmed
No new incident, checked Aug 19-22 — draft2 finding	Independent re-check for any new vessel strike, seizure, or Iran-related military incident, Aug 19-22
Fired Aug 18 — CONFIRMED, negative, cleared the bar	The 60-day MoU window formally lapsed without a signed deal ; Iran says the US breached it first, Trump says "no time schedule" (softened Aug 19)
Fired Aug 17, logged Aug 18 — CONFIRMED, negative, new target named	Trump threatened Oman ("we'd handle them very easily") if it "gets in the way" of reopening the Strait
Reported Aug 17-18 — CONFIRMED, negative	Strait of Hormuz traffic collapsed to 3-5 weekend transits vs. 31 the prior weekend vs. ~110/day pre-war baseline (re-checked; see The Facts)
Fired Aug 18, logged Aug 20 — negative, isolated so far	A commercial vessel struck by an unknown projectile in the Strait , engine damage, one crew injury
Fired Aug 14-15, logged Aug 16 — continuation, now compounding	Three ADNOC tanker incidents (two Aug 14, one Aug 15) — no injuries, UAE/IRGC attribution, no direct Iranian claim
Reported Aug 13 — continuation, not escalation	Hormuz deal remains unsigned; both sides' compensation demands harden (Reuters, US News, NBC, Washington Post, Al Jazeera, The Hill) — Brent eases ~\$87-90 as traffic stays low
Fired Aug 11, logged Aug 12 — continuation, not escalation	Houthi "double-tap" strike on the cargo vessel Tihamah (Bab al-Mandeb Strait, Red Sea) — 6 killed
Fired Aug 9, found Aug 11 — continuation, not escalation	Houthi drone strike on Saudi Aramco's Jazan refinery (400,000 bpd) — no injuries, fire extinguished same-day
Reported Aug 8-9 — continuation, not escalation	Iranian FM Araqchi calls the Oman deal "very close" but adds a US-compensation demand ; UAE reports another ship hit; Oman condemns "repeated attacks"
Jul 31 - Aug 5 — CONFIRMED, negative, missed by daily checks	Five separate Hormuz tanker/shipping incidents (Gaslog Shanghai, Oman-side explosion, Minoan Pioneer, two Kumzar explosions) — IMO tally now 65 incidents since the war began
Fired Aug 7 — CONFIRMED, negative, new front	Iran-backed Houthi forces struck Najran, Saudi Arabia , wounding 11 civilians — the conflict's first widening to a fourth state
Pending — the real trigger	Whether a fee/compensation/sovereignty compromise both Iran and the US can accept is actually signed AND holds through a full week without a tanker attack
Structural, ongoing	Saudi-led Multinational Maritime Defense Alliance plus the new Aug 7 Saudi-Turkey-Pakistan mutual-defense pact
By Dec 31, 2026	Final US–Iran nuclear deal signed — not fired, pending

The flip line, re-leveled — TRIGGERED Aug 30, and as of Sept 11 a SECOND distinct clause (sustained Brent close above \$100) has now ALSO fired: a confirmed new US combat death, a resumption of direct (disputed) attribution, or a sustained Brent close above \$100 = treat the dip-buy thesis as broken. **As of Aug 30, the "resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper" clause fired** — CENTCOM struck Larak Island.

Brent close above \$100" clause has fired too — three consecutive sessions above \$100, including a close above \$107 on Sept 10, its highest since May 19. Two of the four clauses are now live; the remaining two are not. **As of Sept 1-2, the strikes clause was already firing again at vastly greater scale** — CENTCOM confirms nearly 100 targets struck (~50x Aug 30) plus the war's first direct strikes on Iranian government infrastructure.

US combat death" clause remains unfired (no confirmed US casualty found as of this run); the widening-to-a-further-new-state clause did NOT fire despite Iran's Sept 2 retaliation hitting four countries simultaneously.

this war, so "further new state with confirmed attribution" is not met; Brent rose ~5% (best session in 5 weeks) to ~\$95-96.6 but remains short of a sustained \$100 close. The evidence is nonetheless the largest sin

UPDATE, Sept 6: CENTCOM has now confirmed the Sept 5 tanker strike this pillar had withheld — a 3-tanker retaliation for an IRGC ballistic-missile attack on 2 US Navy warships — and Sept 6 brings further single

clauses (no confirmed US casualty, no confirmed strike on a genuinely new state, Brent short of \$100) — the cut this cycle is modest (no window moved > 2 points) and, unlike the Sept 2 cycle, is AUTO-STAMPED per

upside flip: a signed Hormuz agreement the US actually accepts that holds past a full week without a new shipping attack, fatality, or seizure. Oman's own government confirmed a temporary corridor to

considerably further away, not closer. Watch next cycle for: whether Sept 6's IRGC claims are independently confirmed, whether either side's threatened "much larger"/"significantly larger" response actually materi

Brent close above \$100 — any of which would independently fire a fresh flip-line clause and likely warrant a larger cut. **UPDATE, Sept 8:** Iran's SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei announced intent to declare a "restriction

— a genuine new escalatory signal, corroborated by 8+ independent outlets, but explicitly not yet executed (no boundaries announced, no confirmed incident tied to it). This does not independently re-fire any of

Brent ~\$97.29 Sept 7, still short of \$100) — the cut this cycle is modest (no window moved > 1 point) and is AUTO-STAMPED per the delegated daily authority. **UPDATE, Sept 9:** CENTCOM confirms a FIVE-tanker s

second IRGC missile attack on a US Navy warship — a repeat pattern, not a widening to a new state, and no confirmed US casualty, so neither of those clauses fires. Brent crosses \$100/bbl intraday for the first time

but an intraday cross is explicitly not a sustained close, so that clause does not fire either. None of the three unfired clauses independently re-fires this cycle — the cut is modest (no window moved > 1 point) and i

close above \$100 (it is now closer to that threshold than at any prior point in this war), whether the restricted zone is actually declared and enforced, whether the Iran-Oman corridor deal is actually signed, a confir

retaliates for the Sept 8 tanker strike by firing 20 missiles at Jordan's Al Azraq base — Jordan is a repeat target and both sides confirm no casualties, so neither clause fires. Houthis forces seize the Yemeni port of M

priced, and no strait closure has actually been confirmed, so this doesn't fire a clause either. Brent now trades above \$100 for a second straight session — more persistent than Sept 9's intraday cross and the close

sustained call. None of the three unfired clauses independently re-fires this cycle — the cut is modest (no window moved > 1 point) and is AUTO-STAMPED per the delegated daily authority. **UPDATE, Sept 12:** the

Mayyun (Perim) Island inside Bab al-Mandeb itself, with fighting continuing for Zuqar Island (6+ independent outlets), and Brent has held a fifth straight session near/above \$104. Still, no strait CLOSURE or shipping

actor/theater), and no US casualty is confirmed, so that clause doesn't fire either — this is a severity escalation within the already-fired sustained-Brent and direct-strikes clauses, not a fresh clause. The cut is mode

next cycle for: whether the Houthis actually close or interdict shipping through Bab al-Mandeb (vs. merely holding its shores/islands), whether Zuqar Island's contested status resolves, a confirmed US combat deat

distinct Saudi oil-infrastructure strike — the East-West Pipeline (Petroline), hit by drones launched from Iraqi territory Sept 10 (Saudi MFA statement Sept 11) — does not independently fire either the widening clau

confirmed); sponsorship remains undetermined (Trump's single hedged "probably Iran" remark is not treated as fact). The cut is small (no window moved > 1 point) and, because this is a FULL WEEKLY refresh, is LE

categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority. Watch next cycle for: whether responsibility for the pipeline strike is claimed or independently confirmed, whether the Houthis actually close or interdic

genuinely new state.

My Decision

COMMITTED — SEPTEMBER 14, 2026 (2026-09-14_draft) · LIGHT DAILY TOUCH · AUTO-STAMPED

P (2026-09-14_draft, COMMITTED — light daily touch, auto-stamped): 1 / 1 / 18 / 38 / 70 · Prior P (2026-09-13_draft, light daily touch, committed (uniform) · This pillar's signals: 1mo -4.70 · 3mo -5.10 · 6mo -3.58 · 1yr -1.25 · 3yr +1.76 · Master (equal-weight) this cycle: 1mo -1.59 · 3mo +0.33 equal-weight (Neutral) / +0.87 horizon-weighted (Mild Bull) — no call-band flip vs. yesterday's set

Sept 14 LIGHT DAILY touch (score set 2026-09-14_draft), this version — yesterday's up-move is retraced, because the meeting it rested on was called off: the Salalah ministerial never convened. C to create conditions conducive to a constructive dialogue," with **no replacement date** — corroborated across Arab News, the Washington Post, CNN, Gulf News and Malay Mail. Bahrain had ruled out attacking a Saudi request citing Yemen, which is **single-party-sourced and not used to move P**. FM Araqchi separately said the Iran-Oman understanding "would not mean reopening of the Strait of Hormuz." **RATED DOWN to 1/1/18/38/70** (1mo -2, 3mo -2, 6mo -2, 12mo -1, 36mo flat). This is an ordinary light daily touch, research access was full, and Step 6 verification passed clean — so per the runbook's (auto-stamped)". **What would change my mind:** Oman naming a firm new date with Saudi and Bahraini attendance confirmed would re-fire the de-escalation read faster than it retraced.

Sept 13 LIGHT DAILY touch (score set 2026-09-13_draft), prior cycle — the first UPWARD re-rate on this pillar since August 6, now superseded by the postponement above: ONE sufficiency-clearing **ministry announced on Friday Sept 11 that the foreign ministers of Iran, the six GCC states and Iraq will convene in Salalah, Oman on Monday Sept 14 to discuss navigation through the Strait of Hormuz** — short-term management of the waterway, building on weeks of Oman-mediated Iran-Oman talks. This is the first time high-level officials from Iran and the six GCC states have gathered in one place since the war, as an effort "to promote better understanding among the countries of the region and help strengthen shared regional security." Corroborated by 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera Sept 11, Dawn Sept 12, Reuters Sept 12), comfortably clearing the sufficiency bar. **Four counterweights, all new and dated, are logged and sized in — they are why this is +2 points and not a reversal:** (1) Bahrain announced Sept 12 it will NOT sign a NO signed Hormuz deal is expected out of Monday's meeting — this is a convening, not an outcome; (2) the agenda concerns *managing* transit through a strait Iran still controls, with Tehran weighing a sea blockade; (3) the kinetic war did not pause — on Sept 13 a commercial vessel was attacked near Qeshm Island inside Hormuz, killing one and wounding four (an Iranian official blamed the "US terrorist enemy" struck Jazan in Saudi Arabia causing injuries and damaging a mosque, and Houthi forces continued trading strikes with Yemen's internationally recognised government over Bab al-Mandeb (Al Jazeera live) — Brent gave back 4.24% on Friday Sept 11 to ~\$104.26 — the first meaningful downside session since the sustained->\$100 flip-line clause fired — attributed by wire coverage to this diplomacy plus the already-activated clauses already fired (direct US strikes on Iran proper, Aug 30; sustained Brent close above \$100, Sept 10-11) remain fired and continue to hold — Brent is still above \$100. The upside clause is unambiguous and clean week. An announced meeting at which no deal is expected is not that. **P RE-RATED UP, modestly, to 3/3/19/39/70** (from 1/1/17/37/70) — 1mo +2, 3mo +2, 6mo +2, 12mo +2, 36mo held at 70 (on the near windows where the meeting actually sits, and is sized symmetrically against the 1-to-2-point daily cuts this pillar has been taking all month. **Auto-stamp decision:** this is an ordinary light daily touch, research access was full, and Step 6 verification passed clean. Per the runbook's delegated auto-stamp authority — widened Sept 2 so that it would withhold — **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)".** The *direction* of the move does not change that test: the same rules that justified six weeks of downward

Sept 12 FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-09-12_draft2), prior version — still DRAFT, awaiting Alex's manual review: four parallel adversarial research passes ran across all four qualitative pillars (CLARITY Act, Tokenization, and Fed & Macro each held flat on independent re-check (see those reports). Iran War Risk found ONE sufficiency-clearing new fact beyond the morning baseline: **Saudi Arabia was hit by drones launched from Iraqi territory Sept 10 (Saudi MFA statement/confirmation Sept 11)**, a new target distinct from the already-logged Sept 8 Aramco/Jazan refinery strikes. PRIMARY: Saudi Arabia was struck, causing injuries and material damage, and said it would not retaliate for now at Baghdad's request; corroborated by 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, CNBC, CNN, Times of Israel, ABC News, Reuters, AP, etc.). Iran's own PM ordering a probe, dismissing the Maysan operations commander, and closing the Shalamchah border crossing. **Attribution caveat:** no group has claimed responsibility, and the Saudi MFA statement called Iran "probably" responsible — a SINGLE, HEDGED, UNCONFIRMED remark, logged as exactly that, not as fact. **Neither flip-line clause fires:** the widening clause does NOT fire (Iraq has been an active theater, not a new one); the US-casualty clause does NOT fire (no confirmed US military casualty this cycle). The sustained-Brent->\$100 clause continues to hold (~\$104.61 Sept 12, same as the previous day). The Houthis privately signaled they don't want direct US involvement in Yemen (single-source as to substance, consistent with the already-logged MBS-refused-strikes counterweight), and the UAE urging "maximum restraint" — a mild, long-horizon diplomatic data point (1yr/3yr framing only). The Mayyun Island/Bab al-Mandeb seizure was independently re-verified as still holding (Euronews, AP, etc.). **FURTHER, modestly, to 1/1/17/37/70** (from 1/2/18/38/70) — 3mo/6mo/12mo -1 each, 36mo held, 1mo held at the near-floor 1. **Auto-stamp decision:** this is a FULL WEEKLY refresh, not a light daily touch, so stamp authority regardless of move size or how the sufficiency rule was applied. **This set is LEFT AS DRAFT: status draft, NOT stamped, flagged prominently for Alex's manual review.**

Sept 12 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-12_draft), prior cycle: the load-bearing development is that Houthi forces, an Iran-aligned proxy, have moved from "closing in on" to actual island-level control of the Red Sea. Having seized the port of Mocha Sept 10, Houthi forces captured Dhubab and Murad (the last government-held coastal towns) by Sept 11, giving them Yemen's entire Red Sea coastline, and separately seized the port of Aden. Confirmed by 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, NBC News, CNBC, NPR, The National, National Herald). Saudi Crown Prince MBS's request for direct US strikes on the Houthis was refused, with intelligence suggesting they would not accept. Separately, UKMTO's own Warning 133-26 confirms two more vessels struck near Khasab, Oman Sept 10 (one afire); an IRGC claim of a Saildrone strike is single-source and not used to move P. Brent held near \$100, already fired, not a fresh trigger. Neither the widening clause (Yemen is existing theater) nor the US-casualty clause fires — this is a severity escalation of an already-fired flip-line environment, not a new flip-line event. **1/2/18/38/70** — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo 4→2, 6mo 20→18, 12mo 40→38, 36mo 71→70. **Auto-stamp decision:** this is an ordinary light daily touch, research access was full (WebSearch working, local quant refresh ran), and verification passed clean — neither the size of a move nor the severity of the underlying news is by itself a reason to withhold the stamp. **This set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)".** CLARITY Act and Tokenization held flat on independent re-check, tenth cooler than consensus — see those reports.

Sept 11 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-11_draft), prior cycle: the load-bearing development is that this pillar's own **"sustained Brent close above \$100" flip-line clause has FIRED**. Brent ended its highest in nearly four months, since May 19 — with WTI closing above \$102 for the first time since May (Rigzone/Bloomberg wire Sept 10, TradingEconomics, Vantage Markets, NAI500 — 4+ independent), ~3% give-back. That is three consecutive sessions above \$100, two of them confirmed closes and one decisively so; the two prior cycles called this a near-miss and explicitly flagged it for watching, and the current cycle is as that Thursday's level — an intraday read, not the close. Second, fuller reporting landed on the Sept 9 shipping wave: Iran attacked 10 vessels near Hormuz (2 US-linked ships, 8 oil tankers), the largest de-escalation since the RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill). A merchant seafarer is not a US service member, so the confirmed-US-combat-death clause does NOT fire; no further new state was struck, so the widening clause does not fire. The transits Sept 9 vs a Kpler 10-day average of 10-13/day. Logged as counterweight: Friday's give-back is attributed to Hormuz diplomacy and the IEA's 2.5 mb/d demand-contraction forecast. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/1/18/38/70** (from 1/2/18/38/70) — 3mo/6mo/12mo -1 each, 36mo held, 1mo held at the near-floor 1. **Auto-stamp decision:** this is an ordinary light daily touch, research access was full (WebSearch/WebFetch working, local quant refresh ran), and verification passed clean — under the rule, clause firing is by itself a reason to withhold the stamp. **This set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)".** CLARITY Act and Tokenization held flat on independent re-check, tenth cooler than consensus — see those reports.

Sept 10 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-10_draft), prior cycle: two new dated facts since the Sept 9 baseline. (1) CENTCOM/Jordan confirm the IRGC retaliated for the Sept 8 five-tanker strike by intercepting 18 state 18 were intercepted, 2 fell in unpopulated areas, no casualties (Al Jazeera Sept 9, MiGFlug, GlobalSecurity.org Day 194, corroborating Jordan's own military statement). Jordan is a repeat target (struck Sept 8, Sept 9, Sept 10). CENTCOM/Jordan both confirm no casualties, so the confirmed-US-casualty clause also does not fire (US KIA count remains 18, unchanged since Sept 4 per GlobalSecurity's own tracker — a separate low-casualty event against CENTCOM's own no-casualties statement). (2) Iran-aligned Houthi forces seized the Yemeni Red Sea port city of Mocha on Sept 10, closing in on control of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait — a SECOND gulf of Aden event. Media Line, Times of Israel, Al Jazeera, South China Morning Post, Jerusalem Post, Cyprus Mail), clearing the sufficiency bar. This is the same Houthi/Yemen actor and theater already priced (not a strike on a new actor — outlets describe Houthis as "closing in on" and "threatening" control, not as having executed a blockade — so it does not independently fire a flip-line clause either. Separately, Brent crude has now traded above \$100 for the first time since May; TradingEconomics: ~\$101.25 Thursday Sept 10) — more persistent than Sept 9's single-day intraday cross, but still short of a clean multi-session "sustained" call by this pillar's next cycle, but does not independently fire that clause. Net: a repeat-pattern regional strike plus a new-but-same-actor Yemen/Red Sea territorial escalation, both intensifying the trend already priced without a new actor. **23→22, 43→42;** 1mo held at the near-floor 1 (no further room) and 36mo held flat at 72 (a repeat regional strike and a same-theater territorial shift do not move the multi-year thesis). No window moved more than 1 point, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the FINAL NUMBER's call band did not flip (Neutral→Neutral equal-weight, Mild Bull→Mild Bull horizon-weighted) — so per the runbook's delegated auto-stamp authority this set is **AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)".**

Sept 9 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-09_draft), prior cycle: CENTCOM's own press release ("US Destroys 5 IRGC Tankers After Iran Targets Another American Warship," centcom.mil) confirms US Navy warship M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco (Gulf of Oman), and M/T Derya (Kharg Island) — after the IRGC targeted a US Navy warship with ballistic missiles TWICE over the preceding two days. Corroborated by 5+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, Reuters, AP, etc.). CENTCOM's own release — clears the sufficiency bar. CENTCOM confirms both Iranian missile attempts were evaded and no US personnel were harmed — the confirmed-US-casualty flip-line clause remains unactivated. The state clause does not fire either; this is a repeat pattern, not a fresh category of event. Separately, Brent crude crossed \$100/bbl intraday today (Sept 9) for the first time since July 24 — confirmed by CNBC and Reuters. **Trading ~\$100.44, +2.57%** — a genuine escalation data point and the closest this cycle has come to the flip line, but a single-day intraday cross, not this pillar's own "sustained Brent >\$100" threshold, so it does not fire. The announcement remains in the same not-yet-executed state as the Sept 8 baseline logged it — coverage today still describes boundaries as unspecified, so it is not re-scored a second time. This is a continuation of the trend already priced without a new actor. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly: 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo 7→6, 6mo 24→23, 12mo 44→43, 36mo 73→72.** No window moved more than 1 point, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the FINAL NUMBER's call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral) — so per the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)".**

Sept 8 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-08_draft), prior cycle: Iran's SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei announced on-record (Iranian state TV, carried by Press TV and Tehran Times), Sept 6-7, that Iran would "close the Persian Gulf" "in the coming days," with any vessel entering it placed on Iran's sanctions list; he separately said an Iran-Oman corridor agreement would be signed "in the coming days." Corroborated by 5+ independent outlets (WFLA/Nexstar, GlobalSecurity.org) in addition to Iranian state media — clears the sufficiency bar. This is a genuine new escalatory signal but explicitly a THREAT OF INTENT, not yet executed: Al Jazeera's own headline announced, "and no zone had actually been declared as of this cycle's research cutoff. None of this pillar's flip-line clauses independently fire: DCAS US KIA remains 18 (unchanged since Sept 4), no widening of the US-casualty clause; the sustained-Brent->\$100 clause is short of \$100. GlobalSecurity's Day 192 (Sept 7) blockade count of 92 redirected / 3 disabled / 2 boarded (up from Day 190's 87/3/2 on Sept 3) is a continuation of the already-priced trend, not scored separately. **modestly: 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo 8→7, 6mo 25→24, 12mo 45→44, 36mo held at 73.** No window moved more than 1 point, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the FINAL NUMBER's call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral) — so per the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)".**

Sept 6 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-06_draft), prior cycle: CENTCOM's own on-the-record press release (centcom.mil) now confirms the Sept 5 tanker strike this pillar had explicitly withheld from the public. US forces struck THREE Iranian crude oil tankers on Sept 5 — M/T Downy (permanently disabled off Kharg Island), M/T Stark 1 (permanently disabled near Jask), and M/T Kylo (completely destroyed in the Persian Gulf by an aircraft carrier and a guided-missile destroyer); both ships evaded, no American personnel were harmed. Corroborated by Al Arabiya, Jerusalem Post, CNN, NBC, and 5+ other independent outlets in addition to CENTCOM's own release, and reveals a direct, unprovoked IRGC missile attack on US Navy vessels rather than a quiet single-tanker interdiction. Separately, Sept 6 (today) brings further IRGC claims — three more tankers (Euronews) — which are Iran's own claims only, not yet US-confirmed, and are NOT used to move P; watch next cycle. None of this pillar's flip-line clauses independently fire: DCAS still shows 18 confirmed deaths (including 10 US personnel, a new state), and Brent closed ~\$96/bbl Friday Sept 4 (markets closed Saturday) — still short of \$100. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly: 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo 9→8, 6mo 27→25, 12mo 47→44** (plus-multi-outlet bar (CENTCOM's own release), and the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral, checked both against the prior committed baseline and against an authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**)

Sept 3-5 re-check, held flat: Iran fired a second retaliatory wave Sept 3 on Ahmed al-Jaber AB (Kuwait) and Al Minhad AB (UAE) — a US official confirmed no US-manned facility was hit and no third night of war, so the widening-to-a-new-state clause still does not fire. Brent held roughly flat (~\$95.2-95.75 Sept 4), still short of \$100. Two developments logged, NOT used to move P: (1) Reuters shared images/video of a strike was likely a direct hit by a US munition (JSOW-type glide-bomb fragments identified) — this upgrades the casualty claim's sourcing from single-narrative to independently corroborated by a primary source, but is skeptical," Sept 4, calling it under investigation), and the confirmation resolves attribution of an ALREADY-PRICED Sept 1-2 event rather than describing new escalation, so it does not independently move P. (2) Iran struck an Iranian oil tanker near Kharg Island, Iran's primary oil-export terminal — no CENTCOM or independent Western multi-source confirmation as of this research pass, so per the sufficiency rule this still does not fire. This would be a materially new escalation vector (a direct hit on Iran's core oil-export infrastructure, distinct from the Sept 1-2 tanker-hull strikes). Also noted: Iran reportedly warned the US that an Israeli missile struck the ridge Sept 3, but no such attack has been confirmed as of this run — a live pending trigger, not a fired one. **P HELD FLAT at 1/9/27/47/74. CORRECTION:** this cycle's commit message claimed "AUTO-STAMPED" but was not committed — a bug in that session, flagged here and not corrected retroactively.

Sept 5 FULL WEEKLY refresh (2026-09-05_draft2), this version: independently re-verified via WebSearch. The Sept 5 tanker report has firmed up considerably since the daily touch a few hours earlier: the pillar's own research (18 nautical miles off Kharg Island per Tasnim (Iranian state media); separately, Iran International — a London-based Persian broadcaster editorially independent of and adversarial to Tehran — obtained video of a strike that a strike and warnings occurred. However, AP's own wire story on the incident is headlined "Iran accuses the US of targeting a tanker" — treating it as an accusation, not a confirmed fact — and US CENTCOM's own research pass (distinct from CENTCOM's on-the-record July 14-15 naval-blockade doctrine, under which the Curacao-flagged M/T Belma was disabled via Hellfire-into-smokestack after ignoring warnings — still needs either a primary confirmation (CENTCOM/Pentagon on the record) or independent-of-the-accusing-party corroboration of that specific fact; Iran International's video corroborates that warnings were given, but Iran's own narrative — so this is NOT used to move P this cycle, consistent with the daily touch's conclusion a few hours earlier. WATCH NEXT CYCLE for CENTCOM confirmation or denial. None of the pillar's flip-line clauses independently fire (standing count remains 18 per GlobalSecurity Day 189), no widening to a further new state (Sept 3's Kuwait/UAE strikes were both repeat targets), and Brent held ~\$95-96/bbl Sept 3-4 — up roughly 9% w/ oil prices. **1/9/27/47/74. Full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from the delegated daily auto-stamp policy regardless of move size (here, zero) — left for manual review, and COMMITTED BY ALEX.**

This is a light daily catch-up against the Sept 1 baseline (7/15/32/50/75, auto-stamped) — but it turned into the sharpest single-cycle move since the flip line itself fired Aug 30. **The load-bearing new fact** was that Iran — roughly 50x the scale of the single Aug 30 Larak Island strike — including, for the first time in this war, direct US strikes on Iranian government oil tankers under a newly reported "tanker strike" (Hormozgan governor's office: 4 of at least 5 dead including a 4-year-old, 60+ injured) — CENTCOM has neither confirmed nor denied it, and this claim is explicitly flagged single-narrative-sourced at the core of the pillar. Coordinated IRGC ballistic-missile and drone strikes Sept 2 on US-linked bases in FOUR countries at once (Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait) — all repeat targets, so the widening-to-a-new-state flip-line clause did not fire. CBS News, RFE/RL.

P RE-RATED DOWN SHARPLY: 1mo 7→1, 3mo 15→9, 6mo 32→27, 12mo 50→47, 36mo 75→74. Every window moved under 8 points, but this is the largest front-loaded cut since the Aug 30-31 flip-line. US casualty, no confirmed strike on a genuinely new state, Brent short of \$100, but the already-fired "resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper" clause is escalating sharply in scale, which is what's driving the move.

Still a **dip-watching pillar, not a panic-selling one** — the four-country retaliation hit repeat targets, most projectiles were intercepted, and no US casualty is confirmed. But the trajectory since Aug 30 is not a retreat. There are on-record threatening still-larger responses. A confirmed new US combat death, a confirmed strike on a genuinely new state, or Brent sustaining a close above \$100 would each independently warrant a move.

Why this was originally left as a draft Sept 2, pending manual review: (1) the core wedding-casualty fact — the emotional and political driver of that day's four-country retaliation — is single-narrative-sourced, and the scale was lower than for a cleanly multi-sourced primary event, and this pillar's own research chose not to self-approve a cut resting partly on it; (2) the jump in scale — nearly 100 targets and the war's first-ever escalation this pillar's prior single-incident sizing precedents didn't cleanly cover; (3) both sides were on-record threatening much larger responses ahead ("significantly larger" from Trump, "many times greater" from Iran). Independently flipped the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band (Mild Bull → Neutral) versus the last stamped set — under the rules in force that day, this alone disqualified the set from delegation.

September 3, 2026 update: Alex reviewed this cycle's research (delivered as PDFs Sept 2) and widened the delegated daily auto-stamp policy in CLAUDE.md: a call-band flip and the size of a move are not a gap that cycle, or an unresolved verification inconsistency. This cycle had neither: the research was multi-sourced, and the single-narrative wedding-casualty claim was correctly kept out of the P move under the sufficiency rule. **changed — only the stamping threshold did. COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026.**

Historical note: the paragraph above was the Sept 2 cycle's original manual-review flag, superseded by the Sept 3 auto-stamp policy widening and, again, by this cycle's own auto-stamp. Left here for the audit trail and to recompute.

What Changed Since Last Check

LIGHT DAILY touch, September 14, 2026 (score set 2026-09-14_draft, committed, auto-stamped) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-13_draft committed baseline (3/3/19/39/70).

- ★ ★ **NEW — the Salalah ministerial did not happen. Oman postponed it on Sunday, September 13, with no new date.** PRIMARY: Oman News Agency — "It has been decided to postpone the meeting to create conditions conducive to a constructive dialogue." Corroborated independently by Arab News, the Washington Post, CNN, Gulf News and Malay Mail (Sept 13-14). This is the exact fact y'all were waiting for.
- **The problem is Gulf-Arab buy-in, not the calendar. Bahrain explicitly ruled out attending; no GCC state had confirmed participation** before the postponement; and the **UAE had already confirmed** attendance. Nobody confirmed for is weaker evidence of de-escalation than a meeting announced.
- **Iran says Saudi Arabia asked for the delay, citing the Yemen war, and calls that a pretext — SINGLE-PARTY SOURCED and NOT used to move P.** This is Iran's MFA spokesman characterizing the score. Omani FM Badr Albusaidi posted on X that Oman remains "determined to promote dialogue that contributes to stability and lasting cooperation in our region."
- **FM Araqchi capped the value of what survives: the Iran-Oman understanding "would not mean reopening of the Strait of Hormuz"** (Tehran Times / Mehr News, Sept 13 — Iranian state media; Eurasia Review and Sunday Guardian). He also confirmed the bilateral technical work is real: navigational charts drawn, draft joint statement prepared. That framework survives the postponement, but not the fully retracing.
- **Market reaction — a MARKET PRICE, reported and not scored:** Brent crude pushed past **\$107/bbl (+2.8%, \$107.54 November delivery)** and WTI to **\$102.34 (+2.3%)** on the postponement.
- **Checked and REJECTED as stale:** research this cycle surfaced drone strikes on Oman's Salalah and Duqm ports, which would have been materially escalatory. Those incidents are dated **March 2026** because the search surface presented them without dates.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN to 1/1/18/38/70** (from 3/3/19/39/70) — 1mo -2 (the one near-term de-escalation catalyst evaporated with no replacement date) · 3mo -2 (the GCC realignment most, hold one point above Sept 12 for the surviving Iran-Oman bilateral framework) · 36mo flat (nothing structural moved). Ordinary light daily touch, full research access, verification clean —

Carried forward — the September 13 light daily touch, for continuity:

LIGHT DAILY touch, September 13, 2026 (score set 2026-09-13_draft, committed, auto-stamped) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-12_draft2 full weekly refresh (still draft, awaiting Alex's manual review).

- ★ ★ **NEW — and for the first time since August 6, it cuts the other way: Iran's foreign ministry announced Friday Sept 11 that the foreign ministers of Iran, the six GCC states and Iran's neighbors agreed on a new framework for maritime navigation.** Agenda: safe and temporary commercial shipping routes, mine clearance, and short-term management of the waterway, built on weeks of Oman-mediated Iran-Oman talks. This began in February. PRIMARY: the Iranian MFA's own statement ("to promote better understanding among the countries of the region and help strengthen shared regional security"); corroborated by Reuters, Observer, The Business Standard, Business Recorder, ARMENPRESS, SBS).
- **Counterweight 1 — incomplete participation:** Bahrain announced Sept 12 that it will not attend the Oman meeting.
- **Counterweight 2 — no outcome expected:** an Iranian official told the Jerusalem Post that no signed Hormuz deal is expected out of Monday's meeting. This is a convening, not a settlement.
- **Counterweight 3 — what is actually being negotiated:** the agenda concerns *managing* transit through a strait Iran still controls, with Tehran weighing a service-fee regime for transiting vessels.
- **Counterweight 4 — the fighting did not pause.** Sept 13: a commercial vessel was attacked near Qeshm Island inside Hormuz, killing one and wounding four (an Iranian official blamed the attack on a Houthi missile). A projectile struck Jazan, Saudi Arabia, causing injuries and damaging a mosque; Houthi forces and Yemen's internationally recognised government continued trading strikes over Bab al-Mandeb.

- **Market corroboration, reported NOT scored:** Brent gave back 4.24% Friday Sept 11 to ~\$104.26 — the first meaningful downside session since the sustained->\$100 clause fired — attributed to a forecast. A market price, not the mover.
- **No flip-line clause fires in either direction.** The two fired downside clauses (direct US strikes on Iran proper, Aug 30; sustained Brent close above \$100, Sept 10-11) both remain fired and closed a full clean week — an announced meeting with no deal expected is not that.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED UP, modestly, to 3/3/19/39/70** (from 1/1/17/37/70) — 1mo/3mo/6mo/12mo +2 each, 36mo held flat at 70. Concentrated on the near windows where the move occurred this month. **AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)"** — an ordinary light daily touch with full research capability, clean verification, and sourcing well above the baseline.

Previous entry — FULL WEEKLY refresh, September 12, 2026 (score set 2026-09-12_draft2, still draft) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-12_draft committed baseline.

- ★ **★ NEW — a third distinct Saudi oil-infrastructure strike this week: Saudi Arabia's East-West Pipeline (Petroline), the kingdom's primary Hormuz-bypass export route, hit by drone strikes** corroborated by 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, CNBC, CNN, Times of Israel, ABC News Australia, OilPrice.com); Iraq's PM ordered a probe, dismissed the Maysan operations commander, and ordered a full investigation.
- **Attribution caveat:** no group has claimed responsibility; Trump's Dublin remark that Iran is "probably" responsible is a single, hedged, unconfirmed statement, not treated as fact.
- **Neither flip-line clause fires:** the widening clause does NOT fire (Iraq already an active theater since the Sept 1 Erbil strike); the US-casualty clause does NOT fire (none confirmed).
- **Logged, not scored:** the BRICS New Delhi summit's joint declaration (Sept 12) urging "maximum restraint," and Trump's account of a private Houthi restraint signal on Yemen — both counter to the widening clause.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN FURTHER, modestly, to 1/1/17/37/70** (from 1/2/18/38/70) — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo/6mo/12mo -1 each, 36mo held flat. **This is a FULL WEEKLY refresh** (full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority regardless of move size).

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 12 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-12_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **★ NEW — a second global oil chokepoint moves from "under threat" to under adversary-aligned control.** Houthi forces, having seized Mocha Sept 10, captured Dhubab and Murad by capturing them the ENTIRE Red Sea coastline, and separately seized Mayyun (Perim) Island inside the Bab al-Mandeb strait, with fighting continuing for Zuqar Island (Al Jazeera, NBC News, CNBC). Sept 10 baseline's "closing in" characterization.
- **Logged, honest counterweight:** Saudi Crown Prince MBS twice asked the President for direct US strikes on the Houthis and was refused (intelligence/targeting support offered instead).
- ★ **★ NEW — UKMT0 Warning 133-26 confirms four projectiles struck two more vessels ~4nm west of Khasab, Oman Sept 10, one set afire** (Gulf News, Maritime Executive, The Hill corroborated).
- **Logged, not scored (single-source):** IRGC's own claim of a strike on a US Navy Saildrone near the Strait entrance — no US/CENTCOM confirmation found.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, moderately, to 1/2/18/38/70** (from 1/4/20/40/71) — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo -2, 6mo -2, 12mo -2, 36mo -1. Neither the widening clause nor the already-fired flip-line environment, sized moderately larger than the routine 1-point daily touches given the scale of the underlying news. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority,** the score is set.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 10 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-10_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **★ NEW — Houthi forces launched a significant ballistic-missile-and-drone attack directly on Saudi Arabian soil Sept 8, hitting Saudi Aramco energy facilities — including the 400,000-barrel-per-day** Energy Ministry confirmed several energy facilities and utilities temporarily halted; Saudi authorities confirmed 73 wounded (NPR, NBC News, Bloomberg, The Times of Israel, US News, Al Jazeera). Saudi Arabia is a repeat target — the widening clause does not fire, but this is materially more severe than prior Saudi-linked incidents.
- ★ **★ NEW — Brent crude closes above \$100/bbl for a THIRD consecutive session, moving decisively to \$105.71-\$108** — the highest since May 19 (Reuters-linked wires, Bloomberg, Energy Intelligence). US strikes plus continuing US-Iran tanker exchanges — the closest this war has come to a sustained >\$100 close, still not formally called fired.
- ★ **★ NEW — the IAEA Board of Governors votes 23-3-8 Sept 9 to refer Iran to the UN Security Council over nuclear non-proliferation breaches** — the first such referral in two decades (Malaysia Today, CDM Press). Iran's Azizi threatens on-record retaliation Sept 11, single-source, not used to move P.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, larger than the recent 1-point touches, to 1/3/19/38/69** (from 1/5/22/42/72) — 1mo held flat at the near-floor 1, 3mo -2, 6mo -3, 12mo -4, 36mo -5. No window moved more than 4 points, master call band unchanged everywhere — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority,** the score is set.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 10 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-10_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **CENTCOM/Jordan confirm the IRGC fired 20 ballistic missiles at Jordan's Al Azraq (Muwaffaq Salti) air base Sept 9, retaliating for the Sept 8 five-tanker strike.** Jordan's armed forces confirmed (GlobalSecurity.org Day 194, Jordan's own military statement). Jordan is a repeat target — the widening clause does not fire; no casualties on either side — the US-casualty clause does not fire.
- ★ **Iran-aligned Houthi forces seized the Yemeni port of Mocha Sept 10, closing in on control of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait,** a second global chokepoint distinct from Hormuz (The Media Line). The actor/theater already priced; no strait closure actually confirmed.
- **Brent crude traded near/above \$100/bbl for a second straight session** (above \$101 Sept 9, ~\$101.25 Sept 10) — more persistent than Sept 9's intraday cross, but still short of a sustained close.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/5/22/42/72** (from 1/6/23/43/72) — 1mo held flat at the near-floor 1, 3mo -1, 6mo -1, 12mo -1, 36mo held flat. No flip-line clause independent of the already-fired flip-line environment, sized moderately larger than the routine 1-point daily touches given the scale of the underlying news. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority,** the score is set.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 9 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-09_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **CENTCOM confirms US forces destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers Sept 8 — M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco (Gulf of Oman), and M/T Derya (Khasab)** over the preceding two days. Corroborated by 5+ independent outlets (NBC News, CBS News, SBS, RedState, GlobalSecurity.org) in addition to CENTCOM's own press release ("US Destroys Five Iranian Tankers, No US Personnel Harmed").
- **Brent crude crossed \$100/bbl intraday Sept 9 for the first time since July 24,** trading ~\$100.44 (+2.57%) on U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strike fears (CNBC, ABC News) — the closest that cycle has come to a sustained close.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/6/23/43/72** (from 1/7/24/44/73) — no window moved more than 1 point, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority,** the score is set.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 8 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-08_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **Iran SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei announces on-record, Sept 6-7, that Iran will declare a new "restricted zone" from the US Navy's blockade line into the Persian Gulf, sanctioning** Anadolu Agency, Newsbytes, WFLA/Nexstar, GlobalSecurity.org) in addition to Iranian state media (Press TV, Tehran Times) — clears the sufficiency bar.
- **This is a threat of intent, not yet executed:** Al Jazeera's own Sept 7 explainer says boundaries have yet to be announced; no zone has actually been declared. A parallel claim of an imminent strike is not that.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/7/24/44/73** (from 1/8/25/45/73) — 1mo held flat at the near-floor 1, 3mo -1, 6mo -1, 12mo -1, 36mo held flat. No flip-line clause independent of the already-fired flip-line environment, sized moderately larger than the routine 1-point daily touches given the scale of the underlying news. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority:** status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)".

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 6 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-06_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **CENTCOM's own press release confirmed the Sept 5 tanker strike this pillar had withheld: THREE Iranian tankers struck (M/T Downy, M/T Stark 1, M/T Kylo) in retaliation for an Iranian** Post, CNN, NBC, and 5+ other outlets. Both US ships evaded, no American personnel harmed.
- **Sept 6's single-source IRGC claims of further strikes on 3 more tankers, 3 "US-linked" vessels, and a US naval drone** (Al Jazeera live blog, Euronews) remained US-unconfirmed — not used to move P.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/8/25/45/73** (from 1/9/27/47/74) — no window moved more than 2 points, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority,** the score is set.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 5 FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-09-05_draft2, committed by Alex), for continuity:

- ★ **★ NEW — Iran fired a second retaliatory wave Sept 3 on Kuwait and UAE, both REPEAT targets.** A US official confirmed no US-manned facility was hit; the widening-to-a-new-state clause is not that.
- ★ **★ NEW — Sept 5: the Iranian-flagged NITC tanker STARK 1 reportedly hit by four missiles ~6nm off Kharg Island.** Iran's Tasnim (state media) makes the claim; Iran International (independent) also reports the claim. Iran's own wire story is headlined "Iran accuses the US of targeting a tanker" (an accusation, not a confirmed fact); CENTCOM has not confirmed or denied it. NOT used to move P per the sufficiency bar.

- **Reuters shared images/video with four independent weapons experts corroborating the Sept 1 Kuhestak wedding-strike casualty claim as likely a direct US-munition hit** — resolve responsibility. NOT used to move P.
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 1/9/27/47/74.** No flip-line clause independently fired this week (no confirmed new US combat death, no widening to a further new state, Brent short of \$100) policy, so it went to manual review — **COMMITTED BY ALEX SEPTEMBER 5, 2026.**
- **Correction:** the same-day earlier 2026-09-05_draft's commit message claimed it was auto-stamped, but config/scores.json's status field was never actually advanced — a bug in that session. retroactively.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 2 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-02_draft, committed), for continuity:

- ★ **★ NEW — CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes Sept 1-2 hit nearly 100 targets across Iran, ~50x the scale of the Aug 30 strike.** IRGC air-defense sites, radar, mine-laying capability, comms UPI.
- ★ **★ NEW — for the first time in this war, the US struck Iranian government oil tankers directly (engine rooms),** under a newly reported "tanker for tanker" policy.
- ★ **★ NEW, SINGLE-NARRATIVE-SOURCED at the core fact — a US strike reportedly hit a wedding party in Kuhestak, Hormozgan.** Hormozgan governor's office: 4 of at least 5 dead (incl. used to move P — reported as context for the retaliation it triggered.
- ★ **★ NEW — Iran's IRGC retaliated Sept 2 with coordinated strikes on FOUR countries at once: Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait.** All four are repeat targets — does NOT independently fire the US combat death.
- **NEW — Brent rose ~5% Tue Sept 1 (best session in 5 weeks) to ~\$95-96.6; WTI ~\$91-92** — still short of the \$100 flip line. Both sides now on-record threatening larger future action (Trump CNBC).
- **BTC traded at \$76,581.44 (Sept 2)** — down from \$78,038.78 (Sept 1, Bitstamp), a real risk-off move.
- **Score decision: RE-RATED DOWN SHARPLY to 1/9/27/47/74** (from 7/15/32/50/75) — 1mo -6, 3mo -6, 6mo -5, 12mo -3, 36mo -1; front-loaded, kept under the 8-point threshold, but this Sept 2 for Alex's manual review (single-narrative wedding-casualty fact, genuinely novel scale, both sides threatening larger future action, and the master call band flip Mild Bull → Neutral); CENTCOM auto-stamp policy so a call-band flip and move size no longer withhold the stamp by themselves.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 1 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-01_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **A THIRD Hormuz tanker hit this week, Aug 31, CONFIRMED via UKMTO plus multi-source reporting.** The Liberian-flagged VLCC Senegal Prosperity was struck by three unknown projectiles, casualties. Follows the already-priced Metro Venetian (Aug 24) and Al Salam II (Aug 25).
- ★ **Iran's army claims a drone strike on the UAE's Al Minhad Air Base; the UAE Ministry of Defense DENIES the base was targeted while CONFIRMING a cross-border drone incursion.** IIR approaching from Iran — corroborated by CBS News, Al Jazeera, Breitbart, Yahoo, Jerusalem Post, ABC News, Seatrade Maritime, and Iran International.
- ★ **President Trump said on-record Aug 31 he is still weighing further strikes on Iran,** calling it "a relatively little war for us" (CBS News, Breitbart, Yahoo) — not a de-escalation signal.
- **Brent continued higher into Sept 1 (~+2% Tuesday, multiple market-desk reports)** — second straight cycle of gains on this news thread; Jordan struck again Aug 30-31 but remained a repeat target.
- **BTC traded at \$78,038.78 (Sept 1)** — down from \$78,447.16 (Aug 31, Bitstamp).
- **Score decision: RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 7/15/32/50/75** (from 9/17/34/51/75) — 1mo -2, 3mo -2, 6mo -2, 12mo -1, 36mo flat; no single new fact independently fired a fresh flip-line; strike night was not yet a sustained campaign. **AUTO-STAMPED** per delegated daily authority: light daily touch, no window moved >2 points, master call band unchanged vs. the last stamped.

Carried forward — what changed in the Aug 31 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-08-31_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **Resumed direct US strike on Iranian territory, Aug 30, CONFIRMED via on-record CENTCOM spokesperson (Capt. Tim Hawkins) plus 20+ independent outlets.** US forces struck two Iranian tankers in the Strait — first acknowledged US strike on Iran since Jul 29, ending the ~28-30-night clean streak. **Fired this pillar's own pre-declared downside flip line** ("a resumption of direct US strikes on Iran").
- ★ **IRGC retaliatory ballistic-missile strikes on two US-linked Jordan airbases, Aug 30-31, CONFIRMED via Jordan's own military statement.** King Hussein and Al-Azraq airbases targeted; US interceptors; IRGC confirmed casualties at Larak (no precise toll); no confirmed US casualty from either event.
- **BTC traded at \$78,447.16 (Aug 31)** — up from \$77,666.16 (Aug 29, Bitstamp).
- **Score decision: RE-RATED DOWN, front-loaded, to 9/17/34/51/75** (from 14/22/38/54/76) — 1mo -5, 3mo -5, 6mo -4, 12mo -3, 36mo -1, sized to a single resumed-strike-night shock. AUTO-STAMPED.

Carried forward — what changed in the Aug 29 full weekly refresh (score set 2026-08-29_draft, held P flat, left as draft, now superseded), for continuity:

- ★ **"Operation Economic Outcast" sanctions package, Aug 24, CONFIRMED via direct fetch of home.treasury.gov (sb0613, sb0614) and an OFAC recent-actions entry.** ~60 entities/individuals on the list; Switzerland under five EO 13902 sectoral determinations; corroborated by state.gov, TRM Labs, Chainalysis, CryptoTimes, law-firm alerts. **For the first time, digital assets was named a sanctions target** — crypto-specific — unlike the "promised, not landed" sanctions rhetoric this pillar discounted through Aug 22. Continued Aug 28 with a Bank Melli-Dubai designation.
- ★ **★ NEW — Oman's OWN Foreign Ministry co-confirmed a temporary Hormuz corridor, Aug 25, CONFIRMED via direct fetch of fm.gov.om/en/53722.** A genuine upgrade: every prior pillar had been "temporary" — Terms: temporary 7-mile joint navigational corridor, joint mine-clearing project, continuing talks toward a permanent corridor. Still "temporary" — Iran itself said Aug 26 the Strait "remains closed".
- **NEW — two more Hormuz "unknown projectile" tanker incidents,** Aug 24 (off Oman, engine-room damage, disabled, no casualties, UKMTO) and Aug 27 (fire onboard, extinguished, crew rescued).
- **NEW — CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper's on-record briefing, Aug 28:** Iranian sea mines cleared from the shipping lanes; ~1,500 vessels transited since blockade enforcement began; US Navy, National, Washington Times, The Hill, RedState, IranWire).
- **NEW — IMO's six-month casualty count settles at 19-20 dead** across 68-70 incidents — the upper end of the prior 15-19 range.
- **NEW — Trump announced Aug 25 the Strait had been demined,** with a "zero tolerance" policy on new mines (Reuters, Axios, France24, US News) — undercut two days later by the Aug 27 Iran claim.
- **NEW — first confirmed Hormuz transit-volume uptick of the whole crisis: +30%+ week-over-week** for the week of Aug 17-23 (USNI News/Lloyd's List) — 114 transits vs. 87 the prior week.
- **NEW, FLAGGED AND NOT USED — an IRGC spokesman's Aug 26 claim of an Iran-Oman Hormuz revenue-sharing agreement** (Sepah News, Iranian state military source) is unconfirmed; "interim framework" with no fees — single-source, explicitly not the US-accepted deal this pillar's flip line requires.
- **Brent eased for a SECOND straight week:** ~\$88.24 (Aug 25) → ~\$89.13-89.3 (Aug 27) → ~\$88.29-90.55 (Aug 28), down from ~\$93-95 (Aug 20-21) — moving further from the \$100 flip line.
- **No new confirmed US combat death Aug 22-29;** no new US/CENTCOM strikes found (GlobalSecurity Day-181 tracker, 28th consecutive clean night).
- **BTC closed at \$77,666.16 (Aug 29)** — up modestly from \$77,266.84 (Aug 22, Bitstamp).
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 14/22/38/54/76** — the confirmed sanctions escalation and the confirmed Oman corridor upgrade roughly offset; neither independently clears the sufficiency threshold (excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority).

Carried forward — the abandoned Aug 28 daily catch-up draft (2026-08-28_draft), for audit continuity: that draft first logged the two Aug 24/27 tanker incidents, Trump's Aug 25 demining claim, and the IRGC revenue-sharing claim; it was researched and re-verified all of it fresh (see above) rather than carry it forward on trust. Treated as not-delivered, same discipline as the Aug 17-21 gap.

Carried forward — what changed in the Aug 22 full weekly refresh (score set 2026-08-22_draft2, committed by Alex Aug 23), for continuity: Background, for completeness: Aug 17, 18, and 20 drafts were each researched but never delivered (2 of 6 reports touched) before stopping without finishing render/selfcheck/archive/commit; the Aug 22 morning catch-up treated all four as not-delivered and independently re-verified via four parallel primary-source research passes; the Aug 22 evening catch-up researched the pillar again and ran a second, dedicated adversarial pass.

- **Aug 17/18/20 drafts (never delivered):** held flat, then cut to 17/25/38/54/76, then cut further to 16/24/38/54/76 on the lapsed MoU window and the UAE missile claim (framed as a "novel claim").
- **Aug 21 (partially delivered, then abandoned):** a session began delivering the Aug 20 draft's numbers but updated only 2 of 6 reports and never ran render/selfcheck/archive/commit — tre

Retrieved & graded September 14, 2026, LIGHT DAILY too (score set 2026-09-14 draft; earlier sources below still stand for facts not re-checked this cycle) — click and judge the quality yourself. Official/primary sources first, then re-affairs' own announcement of the Sept 14 Iran-GCC Hormuz ministerial in Salah, Oman; Al Jazeera, Dawn, Arab News, Oman Observer, The Business Standard, Business Recorder, ARMENPRESS and SBS corroborating; Bahrain's naval vessel attack and the Jazan projectile; TradingEconomics/Forbes on Brent's Friday give-back (market price, not secured).

- **September 14 LIGHT DAILY touch (this cycle):** *Iran News Agency (ONA) — state news agency statement, Sunday Sept 13, 2026: The Salalah regional meeting is “postponed to a later date ... in order to discuss* Albusaidi — post on X reaffirming Oman’s commitment to regional dialogue (primary) · Arab News, “Oman says Hormuz talks with Iran, Gulf states postponed” (Sept 13) · The Washington Post, “Oman postpones regional talks with Iran, Gulf states” (Sept 13) · Reuters, “Oman postpones regional talks with Iran, Gulf states” (Sept 13) · Gulf News, “Oman postpones GCC-Iran meeting on Strait of Hormuz as oil prices rise on supply fears” (Sept 13-14; also the source for Iran’s MFA spokesman attribution of \$102.34, *market prices*) · Malay Mail, “Oman postpones Iran-Gulf talks on Strait of Hormuz” (Sept 14) · Tehran Times / Mehr News, “FM Araqchi: Oman understanding not enough to reopen Hormuz” (Sept 13 — Iranian state media) · Eurasia Review and Sunday Guardian (Sept 14) — corroborating the Araqchi statement · *Checked and excluded as stale:* Seatrade Maritime, Argus Media, Times of Israel and Gulf News reporting on drone strikes at Salalah.
- **September 13 LIGHT DAILY touch (prior cycle):** Iranian Ministry of Foreign Affairs — announcement (Friday Sept 11) that Iran will meet the GCC foreign ministers and Iraq in Salalah, Oman on Monday Sept 14 to discuss the region and help strengthen shared regional security” (primary) · Al Jazeera, “Iran says will discuss Strait of Hormuz with Gulf states on Monday,” Sept 11 · Dawn, “Tehran agrees to engage Gulf states over Hormuz” (Sept 11) · Business Standard · Business Recorder · ARMENPRESS · SBS — 6+ independent corroboration of the meeting, its date, its ministerial level, and its agenda (safe/temporary shipping routes, mine clearance, short-term maritime security, counterweight · Jerusalem Post, “No signed Hormuz deal expected yet from Oman, Gulf States meeting on Monday, Iranian official says” — logged counterweight · Al Jazeera live blog, Sept 13 — commercial vessel attacked (established), Houthi projectile on Jazan, continued Bab al-Mandeb fighting · TradingEconomics and Forbes — Brent’s 4.24% Friday Sept 11 give-back to ~\$104.26, reported as a market price and explicitly not used to move prices.
- **September 12 FULL WEEKLY refresh (prior cycle):** Saudi Arabia’s Ministry of Foreign Affairs — official statement confirming drone strikes on East-West Pipeline (Petroleum) pumping stations near Riyadh/Medina, Sept 11 reporting, satellite imagery of fire/smoke at the pumping stations near Al Mesba’ah and Al Dhakra · Iraqi PM’s office (via corroborating outlets) — probe of the Maysan operations command, commander dismissed, Shalabi (single, hedged, unconfirmed); Houthis privately signaled no desire for direct US involvement in Yemen (single-source as to substance) · BRICS New Delhi summit — joint declaration, Sept 12, signed by all members plus Iran (single, hedged, unconfirmed) · Eurasia Review, Middle East Eye, ZeroHedge — re-verification that the Mayyun (Perim) Island/Bab al-Mandeb seizure still holds · TradingEconomics — Brent ~\$104.61 Sept 12, unchanged from the morning baseline.
- **September 12 light daily catch-up (prior, this morning):** Al Jazeera (“Can the Houthis close the Red Sea after seizing the Yemen coast?,” Sept 11) — Houthi capture of the entire Red Sea coastline · NBC News, CNBC, NDTV, Mayyun (Perim) Island, fighting continuing for Zugar Island; Saudi Crown Prince MBS’s request for US strikes on the Houthis refused · UKMTO Warning 133-26 (1910 UTC Sept 10, official) — four projectiles struck two vessels in the Khasab incident · TradingEconomics, psuconnect.in — Brent settled ~\$104.61 Sept 12, a fifth consecutive session near/above \$100 · GlobalSecurity.org, Iran War 2026 Day 196 (Sept 11) — IRGC claim of a Saldrone strike (Sept 13) vs. \$77,289.66 (Sept 12) vs. \$77,063.25 (Sept 11) vs. \$77,993.99 (Sept 10).
- **September 11 light daily catch-up:** Rigzone (Bloomberg wire, Sept 10) — Brent ended Thursday up more than 6% above \$107 after trading above \$108 intraday, highest in nearly four months; WTI closed above \$102, highest on the week; cites Hormuz diplomacy and the IEA’s 2.5 mb/d 2026 demand-contraction forecast as the counterweight · Vantage Markets, NAI500 (Sept 10) — corroborating Brent above \$100-102 on Hormuz strikes · GlobalSecurity.org, Iran War 2026 Day 195 (Sept 10) — direct fetch returned HTTP 404 (Sept 10) used alone to move P).
- **September 10 light daily catch-up:** Al Jazeera (Sept 9), MiGFlug, GlobalSecurity.org (Iran War 2026 Day 194) — corroborating reporting on Jordan’s own military statement confirming the IRGC fired 20 ballistic missiles at Jordan (Sept 9) · Media Line, Times of Israel, Al Jazeera, South China Morning Post, Jerusalem Post, Cyprus Mail — corroborating reporting on the Houthi seizure of the Yemeni port of Mocha, Sept 10, closing in on control of the Bab el-Mandeb · Brent ~\$101.25 Thursday Sept 10 · standing DoD casualty records (checked directly) — 18 confirmed as of Sept 4, unchanged; a separate low-quality aggregator’s claim of a fresh KIA figure checked and rejected as unconfirmed (Sept 8).
- **September 9 light daily catch-up:** CENTCOM (centcom.mil) — official press release, “US Destroys 5 IRGC Tankers After Iran Targets Another American Warship” (Sept 8, primary source): M/T Kaviz, M/T Charmarin, M/T Houshmand · GlobalSecurity.org — corroborating reporting on the same CENTCOM statement and the two IRGC missile attempts on a US Navy warship, both evaded · CNBC — “Brent crude tops \$100 as U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strikes stock prices” (Sept 8) · casualty records (checked directly) — 18 confirmed as of Sept 4, unchanged · GitHub Actions data-fetch workflow — BTC \$79,052.40 (Sept 9) vs. \$78,435.62 (Sept 8) vs. \$79,090.41 (Sept 7).
- **September 8 light daily catch-up:** Press TV, Tehran Times (Iranian state media) — Mohsen Rezaei’s (SNSC secretary) on-record statement, Sept 6-7, announcing intent to declare a “restricted zone” from the US Navy’s 17th Fleet “in the coming days” · Al Jazeera (“Can Iran enforce a restricted zone in the Strait of Hormuz?,” Sept 7 explainer, noting boundaries not yet announced), The Hill, RTE, Anadolu Agency (aa.com.tr), Newsbytes, WFLA/NextGen (Sept 7) · Iran War 2026 Day 192 update (Sept 7): blockade count 92 vessels redirected, 3 disabled, 2 boarded (vs. Day 190’s 87/3/2, Sept 3) · standing DoD casualty records (checked directly) — 18 confirmed as of Sept 4, unchanged · GlobalSecurity.org, Iran War 2026 Day 191 (Sept 7) vs. \$79,090.41 (Sept 7) vs. \$80,338.98 (Sept 6).
- **September 6 light daily catch-up:** CENTCOM (centcom.mil) — official press release, “CENTCOM Destroys 3 IRGC Oil Tankers After Iran Targets 2 U.S. Navy Warships” (Sept 5, primary source) · Al Arabiya English, Jerusalem Post, Reuters, ship names (M/T Downy, M/T Stark 1, M/T Kilo) and the IRGC ballistic-missile attack on 2 US Navy warships · Al Jazeera live blog (“Iran war live: IRGC claims attacks on 3 oil tankers and 3 US-linked ships,” Sept 5) · not US-confirmed, NOT used to move P · standing DoD casualty records (checked directly) — 18 confirmed as of Sept 4, unchanged · TradingEconomics / multiple market-desk reports — Brent ~\$96/bbl Friday Sept 4 closed at \$79,929.30 (Sept 6) vs. \$79,646.11 (Sept 5).
- **September 3-5 re-check:** GlobalSecurity — Iran War 2026 Day 188-189 updates (Sept 3-4): Iran’s second retaliatory wave hit Ahmed al-Jaber AB (Kuwait) and Al Minhad AB (UAE), both repeat targets; a US official confirmed the strikes · at 18 · Reuters (via Spokesman-Review, Nuktra, Tribune, TBS News, unnn.au) — four independent weapons experts’ forensic analysis of images/video verified by Reuters, concluding the Sept 1 Kuhestak wedding strike was not US-confirmed, Sept 4 · Times of Israel liveblog, Euronews, Newswire.lk — Sept 5 Iranian-media-only (Farsi) report of a tanker strike near Kharg Island, unconfirmed by CENTCOM or any independent source · Critical Threats/ISIP — on Israel; IDF took the ridge Sept 3, no such attack confirmed as of this run.
- **September 2 light daily catch-up — CENTCOM-confirmed strikes plus multi-source reporting on the retaliation:** Axios, CNBC, CNN, Bloomberg, UPI — corroborating reporting on the CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes on Iranian cruise-missile/drone launchers and the first-ever direct US strikes on Iranian government oil tankers under a newly reported “tanker for tanker” policy · Al Jazeera, CBS News, Yahoo, UPI — reporting on the Kuhestak wedding strike · Reuters, Sept 4 · CBS News the US has neither confirmed nor denied it — flagged single-narrative-sourced at the core fact level, per this report’s own sufficiency rule) · Al Jazeera, Yahoo, CBS News, RFE/RL — corroborating reporting on the strikes and the absence of a confirmed new US combat death · CNBC — Trump’s “significantly larger response” threat and an unnamed senior Iranian military source’s “many times greater” quote · multiple market-desk reports — Brent ~\$76,581.44 (Sept 2) vs. \$78,038.78 (Sept 1).
- **September 1 light daily catch-up — UKMTO log plus multi-source reporting:** UKMTO — Senegal Prosperity incident log, Aug 31 (VLCC struck by three unknown projectiles ~17nm NE of Khasab, Oman; port side, en route to Salalah) · Seatrade Maritime, Iran International — corroborating reporting on the Al Minhad Air Base drone-strike claim (Iran’s army) and the UAE Ministry of Defense’s on-record denial of the target claim plus confirmation of an Iranian source’s Sept 31 remarks that he is still weighing further strikes on Iran (“a relatively little war for us”) · multiple market-desk reports (e.g. Bloomberg’s Sept 1 oil roundup) — Brent ~+2% Tuesday Sept 1 on fresh-clash fears · Bitstamp.
- **August 31 light daily catch-up — on-record statement plus multi-source reporting:** CENTCOM spokesperson Capt. Tim Hawkins (on the record, via Bloomberg/CNBC/NBC/Newsweek) — confirms the Aug 30 strike on the Khasab wedding strike · Bloomberg — “Iran War: US Strikes Rocket Launchers Near Strait of Hormuz” (Aug 30) · CNBC — “U.S. strikes Iranian rocket launchers near Strait of Hormuz” (Aug 30) · NBC News — “U.S. forces strike Iranian rocket launchers near Strait of Hormuz” · The Epoch Times, Daily Caller, OANN, FXStreet, Time News, WLT Report (Aug 30, corroborating) · Korea Times, India TV News, RFE/RL — Iran’s IRGC retaliatory ballistic-missile strikes on King Fahd International Airport intercepted · Al Jazeera — “Iran targets Jordan after US attack in a month” (Aug 31) · Reuters/CNBC — renewed exchange weighing on Asian equities and US futures, oil higher · Bitstamp — BTC \$78,447.16 (Aug 31).
- **August 29 full weekly refresh — direct primary-source adversarial fetches:** home.treasury.gov — press releases sb0613 (“Treasury Launches Unprecedented Campaign Against Iranian Regime on Economic D-Day”) and sb0614 (“Treasury Launches Unprecedented Campaign Against Iranian Regime on Economic D-Day”) · TRM Labs, Chainalysis, CryptoTimes (crypto-intelligence corroboration of the 30 BTC/ETH/TRON addresses listed, first-ever digital-assets sectoral designation) · law-firm trade-compliance client alerts (Aug 24-25) · fm.gov — “Iran’s economic corridor and mine-clearing project · Iranian state media (Aug 26) — Iran says the Strait “remains closed” pending US compliance.
- **August 29 full weekly refresh — reporting and data:** UPI, The National, Washington Times, The Hill, RedState, IranWire (Aug 28) — CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper’s on-record mine-clearing/blockade briefing on Aug 28 across 68-70 incidents · USNI News (Aug 21 & Aug 28), citing Lloyd’s List Intelligence — first confirmed Hormuz transit-volume uptick, +30%+ week-over-week (114 vs. 87 transits, week of Aug 17-23) · Reuters (via Yahoo) — “Iran’s economic corridor and mine-clearing project · Iranian state media (Aug 26) — Iran says the Strait “remains closed” pending US compliance.

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